consequences to power

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/17187932.

Rating:
Mature

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra), catradora - Relationship

Character:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Rogelio (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Double Trouble (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Angst with a Happy Ending, Implied/Referenced Child Abuse, Alcohol Abuse/Alcoholism, Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder - PTSD, Complicated Relationships, Kidnapping, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Heavy Angst, Angst and Hurt/Comfort, Not Suitable/Safe For Work, Filipino Catra (Headcanon), Catra (She-Ra) Redemption

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by fivexgs

Summary

catra learns herself, and she represses everything going on in her world. but when she's faced with her greatest enemy, how long can she keep up being a villain?

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

i cant think

Chapter Summary

adora sees a therapist, but it's barely therapy

Chapter Notes

sorry its short im rewriting a lot of this! in adora pov!

The warrior stands on the cliff, her body bruised and battered from intense training. She is known as the savior of her city, Etheria, and the morning light reflects off her golden hair and tiara. Her eyes, a deep shade of blue, are fixed on her mentor, Light Hope, who stands before her with a stoic expression.

Despite her injuries, the warrior refuses to heal herself, using the pain as motivation to keep pushing forward. Light Hope, a woman with vast knowledge of past She-ra users, including the warrior's former prodigy, Mara, continues to push the young trainee to her limits.

As the warrior fights against Light Hope's relentless attacks, she struggles to maintain her balance and grip on her sword. But when she raises her weapon, Light Hope interrupts with a warning to control her emotions and not let them cloud her judgment.

Confused by the warning, the warrior looks at her mentor with disbelief, wondering why she needs to be reminded of something so obvious. As she catches her breath and takes a moment to recover, the warrior continues to train relentlessly, pushing herself to the brink of exhaustion.

Despite the physical and mental toll the training takes on her, the warrior is determined to become the best She-ra she can be. With fierce determination, she lunges forward, sword in hand, ready to face whatever challenges come her way.

Once again, there is silence in the room, only to be interrupted by the ticking of the clock on the wall above Adora. She slowly opens her eyes to the bright light that fills her vision. The lamp on the office desk casts a dim light on the room, and she can see a woman's figure emerging from the light. In the corner of her eye, she notices the fish tank, devoid of any fish.

Adora realizes she has zoned out once again and worries that her therapist will be angry with her. She is also hungry, which makes the situation worse. Her therapist seems annoyed as she waits for Adora to come back to reality, a recurring problem as of late. Adora has noticed that her therapist, who also trains her as She-ra, looks remarkably similar to her in appearance. "Doctor Hope" wears her hair up and has rounded glasses, giving her an uncanny resemblance to her mentor.

The therapist calls out to Adora, who responds with a forced laugh, pretending that she hadn't zoned out. She feels like her sessions are a waste of time, as she subconsciously knows that she could never be She-ra, the superhero, and warrior who manages her issues without a problem. Adora is frustrated with herself for ignoring her own problems and worrying about others, including her therapist.

"If only you knew, Catra," She mumbles to herself.

Adora's lingering thoughts begin to consume her energy, but her therapist interrupts her train of thought with an annoyed sigh. Adora tries to regain her focus, and her therapist, who manipulates and tests her trust, seems to know more about her than Adora realizes. Adora mentions Catra, feeling that she knows more about her than she knows about herself. She recalls how Catra had yelled at her for coming home late, causing her to feel like a ghost in a body without a life.

Adora apologizes to Catra, even though she is not in the room. Her memories play on rewind, and she murmurs on autopilot. Her consultant looks at her with worry, causing Adora to tremble slightly. She is new to the hero business, and even venting about her issues feels like a nuisance. The glare she feels on herself reminds her of the difficult night when she tasted blood and felt the burning sensation on her cheek. The battle from the night before almost broke her, and her heartache is all she can think of. She feels fear when her therapist's hand rests upon her shoulder, but she rests her head on the cold hand for comfort.

"Remember for me, Adora," her therapist says with a cold voice.

everyday routine

Chapter Summary

Catra has conflicting feelings she can't describe. She's impulsive but is making some gravely mistakes.

Chapter Notes

i rewrote a lot

The clouded night sky chills the air, far from the glare of city lights. Swings creak in succession, missing the skin of the "Force Captain" who cackles maniacally, revealing black claws. Her aim is set on the blonde warrior's cheek, puncturing skin as the girl winces and wipes the blood from her hand. The sight of her bloodied face shakes the feline, who sees only her childhood friend Adora through her wince.

"Hindi, Adora wouldn't do this. She would've told me if she were She-ra," she thinks to herself, hissing at the vigilante who covers her cheek.

The familiarity between Adora and the blonde is too striking, and the feline cannot bring herself to end her mission by nearly killing someone who resembles her unrequited crush. Before the hero can react, Catra leaps into the trees, disappearing from the scene entirely. Fuming with anger, she realizes the surprise attack has distracted her from another shipment. She sighs and makes her way to the apartment, removing her maroon mask to reveal her true identity. Her tail, claws, ears, and feline eyes disappear as she hides the mask in her bag, disappearing into the night.

I should go home before Adora realizes I'm gone, although it would be nice to spend time with her. I miss her...

Catra tries to push away her thoughts, convinced that Adora could never feel the same way about her, especially since they're both girls. She attempts to suppress the feelings that make her feel like she's short-circuiting and gives her butterflies in her stomach. All she can do is reminisce about the way Adora's touch would warm her, or how she would nearly purr when Adora ran her fingers through her hair. Her cheeks flush with a light shade of red as she inserts her apartment key into the lock.

Upon entering her dark apartment, she hears the snow gently tapping against the tightly closed windows. However, her shock quickly sets in as she discovers an unconscious Adora lying on the couch, battered and bruised. The blonde is shivering, and Catra is horrified to see the same cuts on her cheek that she inflicted on She-ra only hours before. Her stomach drops, and her blush turns to terror as she rushes to the girl on the couch, her hands trembling as she tries to figure out what to do.

"Adora, please wake up!" Catra's voice cracks as she cries out desperately.

She can hear the slow breaths leaving her roommate's gentle lips and fear grips her heart. Trembling hands move to Adora's unmoved ones, and she locks her fingers with hers. Adrenaline courses through Catra's body as she squeezes Adora's hand, hoping for any sort of sign of life. To her relief, a small grip returns, and she feels the coldness of Adora's skin. Tears stream

down Catra's face as she presses her forehead against Adora's hand.

"I'm here, I'm not leaving you," Catra murmurs, her voice barely above a whisper.

If only that were the truth.

The blaring alarm jolts the woman awake, still sluggish and tangled up in her blankets.

"God shut uuup," she groans.

Looking at the clock, she sees that it's already 12:30PM on Etheria. She moves her pillow over her ear in an attempt to drown out the noise, but the alarm only gets louder. Frustrated, she throws the pillow at the clock, knocking it off the nightstand and shattering it on the floor.

Opening her eyes, she chuckles at the sight of the broken clock, despite the potential trouble it might bring with Adora later. Proud of her small act of rebellion, she sits up and stretches, running a hand through her short hair.

At last, Catra mutters to herself as she removes her clothes and slips into the shorts and crop top she had made from one of Adora's shirts. She calls out for Adora, but then remembers that the blonde is in therapy at this time. She shrugs it off and turns her attention back to the clothing in her hands. As she gazes at the crop top, her face flushes red and her thoughts drift to Adora - her laughter, her smile, and her cheerful demeanor.

Catra catches herself in her thoughts and shakes her head. Adora can be so clueless, but it's also endearing.

"Ugh, stop it, Catra. She's not even into girls," she scolds herself under her breath, throwing the shirt she was holding onto the bed. Despite the racing of her heart and the flush on her cheeks, Catra refuses to acknowledge her true feelings. She lets out a sigh and rummages through her dresser drawer, finding a pair of plain white shorts and a black Paramore t-shirt to wear. As she gets dressed, she notices how neat and organized Adora's bed is compared to her own messy one, causing her to blush again. She quickly averts her gaze and mutters, "I don't like you, Adora. But hurry up and get back already."

She lets out a heavy sigh as she lies back on Adora's bed, her gaze fixed on a framed photo of them as children. It was a simpler time, one she longed to remember. Her eyes narrow as she recalls the day the picture was taken, the pure joy she felt before it all came crashing down when Adora left her for her new friends. She knows their names all too well, for they are on her hit list. They took so much from her, and in her eyes, Adora allowed them to do as they pleased. Her thoughts drift to the things she tries to repress, and tears well up in her eyes. She remembers when she was a baby, her mother spoke to her in Tagalog, and they would play together all day. A gentle smile spreads across

her face, but it quickly fades as she struggles to recall her mother's face.

Her entire childhood was buried in a grave after Weaver destroyed everything she held dear. Weaver tore Catra away from her culture, her childhood, and her trust in others. She was a brainwashed child soldier for the Horde, and it was easier for Adora since she had the opportunity to leave before it got worse. The fact that she had become so close to Adora in just twenty years is both bewildering and terrifying to her. Her heart pounds like a tiger in her chest, and she instinctively wraps her left arm around her elbow.

You took everything from me.

Catra's nails claw into her skin, but she's numb to the pain. All she can feel is the overwhelming need to release the tension coursing through her body. Her lip is caught between her teeth, and her elbow breaks the skin as she digs deeper. Does any of it help? No, but she needs more. Her arms wrap around her trembling frame, and she buries her face into the blanket as she weeps. The ache in her chest won't subside, no matter how much she scratches or digs. The static in her head builds, and the urge to scream is almost too much to bear. She can't risk alerting Melog, their cat. She's paralyzed, unable to move. Her eyes drift towards Adora's empty bed, and the thought of her beloved friend and She-ra only makes things worse. But she won't admit it.

"You promised you wouldn't leave me. You promised you'd be here," she whispers through her tears.

Catra's screams echoed in the emptiness of the room. Her true emotions were only revealed when no one but herself and the meowing cat outside the door was present. She tries to suppress the feelings, but they keep resurfacing and rising up her throat. The burning passion she has for Adora is as internalized as the pain and anger she feels. She longs to unleash it on anyone, but she knows she was raised to be the monster everyone expected her to be. As her eyes dry up, she looks out the window at the snow, which covered everything in sight. It looked cold, and she could relate to that. It's better for her to treat her emotions like snow, covering them up and keeping them hidden.

Suddenly, Adora's gentle voice calls out to her from the door. "Catra, are you home?"

"Obviously not," Catra teases in response.

Adora chuckles at Catra's usual humor and notices the feline staring at the window blankly. She begins to undress behind her, the sound of her bandages rustling against the fabric noticeable. Catra turns to look at Adora, and all her negative emotions dissipate the moment she sees her best friend. The feline doesn't pay much attention to the bandages on Adora's shoulders, all she can think about is Adora herself.

Her stupidly gorgeous eyes.

Catra nods absentmindedly, not really paying attention to what Adora is saying. Her mind is still lost in the thoughts of her friend.

Adora could warm her cold world with just her blue eyes and sunny hair. Catra couldn't imagine living without her by her side.

She tries to focus on the snow hitting the window, hoping it will help her clear her mind. But her thoughts keep spiraling. Suddenly, Adora's voice breaks through her thoughts again.

"I'm going out tomorrow night again, works really been getting on my case about attendance," Adora says, repeating herself.

Catra looks back at Adora and nods, "Okay. Just be careful out there."

Catra's warm and inviting admiration of Adora suddenly came to a complete stop. This was the third night in a row that their plans had been disrupted, and Catra wasn't willing to let it slide so easily. The feeling of being clingy hurt when your person had so many other reasons to leave. Catra found herself starting to chew on her own tongue from the intrusive thoughts she was having.

"It's always work, right?" Catra asked.

"You know I don't have a choice. Listen... it's late. We really need to sleep," Adora deflected.

Of course, swear to diyos (God), this used to never happen.

Catra rolls her eyes at Adora's comment but doesn't pursue it further. It's become a routine that's all too familiar and frustrating for her. She grabs the spare blanket from their bed and retreats to the couch in their rented home. Sharing a bed with Adora is pointless if she won't spend any time with Catra. She hears Adora sigh as she closes the door.

"It's okay, Melog, at least you like me," Catra says, forcing a sad smile.

Melog meows and follows Catra to the couch. Catra sits down and feels her pet curl up in her arms and start to purr. The sound is soothing, and Catra begins to drift off to sleep, her own purring joining in with Melog's.

my roommate

Chapter Summary

catra learns the truth

Chapter Notes

thank you for catching up and reading my fic! my god this is wild

The sky was dark, the clouds blocking any chance of a peaceful night. Catra sat in a vehicle, the windows slightly cracked open, allowing her to watch the clouds hovering above. The storm began to stir, causing her fur to stand on end as she faced upward toward the car's ceiling. She sniffed the air, and her instincts told her it was going to rain. She watched as the first raindrop hit the dirty street, which only made her think about her breakdown from the day before.

"Shit," she muttered to herself.

She knew she had to face the reality of her situation and lie her way through everything and everyone. It wasn't that she believed her self-worth came from spite, but lying was all she had known her whole life. Catra knew the drive would be long and leaned into the car door as Rogelio drove the group to their destination in silence. Rogelio kept his eyes on them both through the mirror, not saying a single word.

The dark sky and looming clouds obscured any hope of a relaxing night. Catra sat in the car, watching the clouds from the slightly cracked window. As the storm brewed, her fur stood on end, and

the smell of rain filled her senses. Watching the raindrops hit the dirty street, her mind wandered to her breakdown the day before.

She couldn't forget that they were all once test subjects, rejected by society and abandoned at a poor orphanage. A man in a tacky suit would visit them often, and she remembered him shaking hands with Weaver. His gifts grew more frequent, but Catra couldn't forget how Weaver would get with them when they had fun.

But she didn't have the luxury of Adora's fortunate upbringing. Hordak had only given her a maroon mask as a gift. The drive to their destination was long, and Rogelio drove in silence, staring at them through the mirror.

Suddenly, Scorpia's voice breaks the silence, asking about the mission. Scorpia tries to remain still, watching families in cars pass by, envying their love and care. She knew she could never be like them, never have a loving family. But there were more important things to focus on, and she nudges Catra with her scorpion pincer to get her attention. Entrapta's laughter interrupts their conversation momentarily, but Scorpia asks Catra if she has told Adora about the mission. Catra is surprised by the question, realizing she had been thinking about telling Adora every day.

"Support me? Yeah, right. Adora always wanted to save everyone, even if it meant sacrificing herself. She doesn't understand that not everyone wants or needs to be saved," Catra replied, her voice laced with bitterness. "And as for her loving me no matter what, that's a load of crap. She left me behind without even looking back. She doesn't love me, Scorpia. She never did."

Scorpia's smile faltered at Catra's harsh words. She didn't know what to say, as she had never seen Catra like this before. She glanced at Entrapta for help, but the tech genius was still engrossed in her video. Scorpia turned back to Catra, her expression full of concern.

"Catra, are you okay?" she asked softly.

Catra shrugged, trying to brush off her friend's worry. "I'm *fine*. Just tired."

Scorpia didn't look convinced, but she didn't push the matter further. The car fell silent again, the only sound coming from Entrapta's video. Catra stared out the window, lost in her own thoughts. She knew she was being stubborn, but she couldn't help the bitterness that filled her heart whenever she thought of Adora. She just wished things could go back to the way they used to be.

Don't be vulnerable.

Entrapta eagerly watches the conversing pair, her mind solely focused on bringing her technological expertise into the discussion.

"I didn't need convincing to join. My passion lies with the machinery calling out to me, and the Horde's technology is in dire

need of advancements," she exclaims, as Catra drifts off into her own thoughts.

Catra feels a dissociation within herself as if her body and mind were engulfed in static like a malfunctioning television. She notices her breathing feeling off and struggles to remain engaged as Scorpia and Entrapta delve into a technical conversation. Despite Scorpia's attempts to include Catra in their discussion, she finds herself disinterested in the topic at hand.

Catra stares at the seat in front of her, unable to comprehend what she should do next. In her mind, she runs through countless scenarios on how to tell Adora about her feelings. However, with each passing thought, her chest tightens, knowing that the outcome will always lead to rejection and invalidation. The thought of it stings the feline, and she can hear Adora's monologue of denial in her head.

"It's not a good idea, Catra! You know you're..."

Suddenly, Catra is jolted out of her thoughts by a loud thud on the car's roof. As the vehicle continues to drive through the city, she hears a blade stabbing into the car's hood. The neon-blue glow of the blade shreds a large square into the roof, causing Catra to hiss in trepidation. Without hesitation, she rips her seatbelt and Rogelio skids off the road. As he calls for backup, Scorpia instinctively gets out of the passenger seat to protect Catra. Through her eyes, Catra sees the shining golden hair of the one person she was thinking about – Adora.

Despite the ache in her heart, Catra's adrenaline pumps through her veins, and her fight response kicks in. Her eyes radiate in the darkness as her pupils narrow into slits. With a hiss, she quickly moves out of Scorpia's way and lunges at Adora, determined to strike. No one will stand in her way. Catra's claws scratch against Adora's gold gauntlets before the warrior swiftly blocks her with the metal on her arm. Her jaw clenches as she growls at the savior of the city.

In the corner of her view, an explosion appears, and Catra's ear twitches as she sees Glimmer and Bow heading in their direction. She tries to go after them, but Adora picks her up by her shirt collar. Frozen in place, all Catra can see is Adora, even in her She-ra form, still looking beautiful. Her muscles tense up, and her chest heaves as her mind races, processing too much at once. Adora speaks to her, but it's all noise to Catra as if she's covered in radio silence.

In a disturbing rage, the feline glares at the woman in anguish. "Adora?" she murmurs under her breath. Nothing else can capture her attention now, except the tremendous fear of Adora getting hurt because of her, which takes over her dissociative thoughts.

“Totally not.” She nervously responds.

"No, you're not going to get away with playing dumb. I'm not fucking stupid," Catra snarled, her patience wearing thin.

Adora tried to come up with an excuse, but before she could finish, Catra lunged at her with all her might. She didn't hold back,

her claws digging into Adora's flesh and leaving deep wounds. Adora cried out in pain, but Catra didn't stop until she realized what she had done. In a moment of realization, she withdrew her claws, but it was too late. Adora had already pulled her off and slammed her onto the pavement. With her sword raised and her weight pinning Catra down, Adora's blood dripped onto Catra's forehead from the wounds inflicted by her claws.

Catra remains frozen beneath Adora, overwhelmed with guilt and disgust toward herself. The reality of what she's done hits her hard, and tears begin to stream down her face as she feels the weight of her actions. All she can hear is the sound of Adora's pain and the blood dripping onto her forehead. Catra feels sick to her stomach and tries to hold back the bile rising in her throat. As Adora slowly lowers her sword, Catra can barely register her surroundings as her mind is clouded with self-hatred. She can see the pain etched on Adora's face, and it only intensifies her feelings of remorse. Adora attempts to laugh through the pain, but it only makes Catra's heart ache even more.

Her tone is dripping with sarcasm as she taunts, "Having fun, princess?" Catra responds by spitting at her, hissing, and struggling to break free from Adora's strong grasp. In response, Adora pushes her harder into the pavement, causing Catra to howl in pain and groan sorely. Tears flow down her face as the stabbing pain in her upper back intensifies, her jaw clenched in agony.

In the background, lightning flashes and rain pelts down as the wind howls around them. Meanwhile, the pink-haired girl and her archer manage to escape. Despite the opportunity to join her heroic team, Adora refuses and chooses to stay, intent on settling unfinished business.

As Adora's fist closes in, painful memories of abuse flood Catra's mind, and she realizes that this is not how she wants to die. She screams out,

"No!"

Thunder rumbles in the background as lightning flashes illuminate the scene. Adora slams her fist into a cement block beside Catra's head, just inches from her skull. Her knuckles become bruised, and she shivers from the cold rain. Adora stares emotionlessly at Catra before moving away, leaving only mental wounds for Catra to bear. Adora retrieves her sword and slides the tip of the blade against Catra's arm, causing her to hiss in agony as blood seeps from her bruised flesh. With a sudden glow, She-ra disappears, and the sword transforms back into a pen at Adora's side.

Adora's sudden appearance startles Catra, causing her hair to stand on end as the rain pours down on them. Before she can react, Adora lands heavily on her, knocking the wind out of her lungs. Catra can feel Adora's weight and the sharp pain of broken glass piercing through her clothes and skin. Adora is bleeding heavily, and her life force is rapidly diminishing. Catra's mind races with confusion and fear as she watches the girl she once knew so well fade away. Adora was her ally, her friend, her savior, and now she was dying in her arms because of their mutual hatred. The sound of the flat line ringing in her head drowns out everything around her, leaving only the silence of death. Catra's heart aches with regret and remorse, knowing that she was responsible for hurting the one person who had always been there for her. She remembers all the times Adora had comforted her when she was down, and how she had risked her life for Catra's sake. Catra was

the villain in this story, the one who had caused all this pain and destruction. Adora was the hero, the one who had tried to stop her, to save her from herself. As time passes, Entrapta and Scorpia finally catch up to them. Rogelio is nowhere to be seen, but Entrapta remains silent, and Scorpia speaks softly to Catra. The shock and emptiness weigh heavily on her mind, and Catra can only watch as Adora slips away, her body going limp in her arms.

"Catra!" Scorpia's voice quakes with fear as she shakes, imagining Catra in unbearable pain. "Are you okay? Do you need medical help? Rogelio is informing Hordak, and he's not pleased... Wait, is that... Adora?"

The rain beats down heavily, drenching their hair, and mixing it with tears and blood. Catra's laughter turns hysterical as she tries to come to terms with the situation, but soon it turns to denial. Too much has happened, and she has been traumatized beyond measure. This moment becomes her breaking point.

Catra remains still, unable to move as she stares at Adora's wounded face. The guilt and regret consume her, and she cannot help but feel responsible for causing Adora's injuries. With a trembling hand, she removes her mask and tosses it against the wall, the sound of it colliding with the bricks echoing in the background. She gently holds Adora's head in her hands and examines her wounds, the five bloody marks traveling from her eyebrow down to her neck and shoulder blade.

The weight of her actions hits her, and she lets out a choked sob. She cannot believe that she has hurt Adora this way, the person who has always been there for her, even when she was at her worst. She feels sickened by herself and the bile rises in her

throat. As she turns away from Adora, she feels the blood smear on her hands and her fists clench tightly.

Her hysterical laughter turns into silent sobs as she speaks, her voice barely audible.

"Why didn't you tell me, Adora?"

Through choked sobs and tears, Catra screams out, wanting to release the tension and rip her chest apart. She feels she deserves every part of this dreadful experience. As she reaches for her tossed cat-helmet, she remembers her "I love you" for Adora, which now haunts her like a shell of their past. The memories of her hurting Adora flash faster in her head, even on missions where she didn't know the truth. She destroyed their shared bed at the orphanage, lost to Adora in training, played and ran off together in their shenanigans, and was comforted by her when Weaver scolded her for doing things that children do.

The promise they made to each other is also clear as day to her, made so long ago but only an hour ago broken. Catra can only hear it repeating in her head, through all of her sobbing and turmoil.

"You look out for me, I look out for you. Nothing bad can happen if we have each other."

Catra quotes what Adora once told her, and she murmurs more in her delusions.

"You promise?"

She grips her knees, thinking back to that moment. She bites her tongue and sobs loudly.

"I promise."

you promise?

Chapter Summary

Adora barely starts remembering last night, but something will start other unwanted memories than the night before

Chapter Notes

a lot of this is rewritten

As Adora jolts upright in her own bed, she immediately feels a sharp ache in her upper body. She tries to get up, but her frail and light-headed state makes it difficult to even move slightly without pain. Despite not being fully aware of her surroundings, Adora wants to get up and find her sword. She knows she needs to become She-ra to heal and leave. However, a familiar hand gently guides her back onto the bed, and she looks up to see Catra calmly watching her. Adora gives her a warm smile, but winces in pain as she settles back onto the bed.

Her hand's cold..

Adora notices Catra's hand is cold, but it's comforting to have her there. Her gaze drifts to the bandages on Catra's shoulder, covering an obvious bruise that Adora immediately knows is her fault. She tries to push away the guilt as she exchanges a glance with Catra, who looks at her with a mix of sadness and understanding. Before Adora can speak, Catra breaks the silence with thin pupils that feel like knives to Adora's heart. Sweat beads on Catra's forehead from her nervousness as Adora watches her, feeling like a deer in headlights.

Catra's concern is evident in her question, "Are you okay?" Adora feels comforted by her presence and responds, "Better that you're here."

However, Catra's condescending stare meets Adora's crystal-colored eyes, and Adora senses that something is off. Catra seems to be in pain and her smile is lacking the usual warmth. Adora feels guilty and tries to push it away as she gazes at the sunlight streaming through the window and onto Catra's face. Despite her pain, Adora still finds herself admiring Catra's features. She tries to give her a warm smile, but it falters into an unpleasant expression. Speaking softly for Catra, Adora says what she wishes Catra would say: "I'm here for you."

“Don't worry, I'm alright.” She soughs.

Adora looks down at her alarm clock, and she instantly catches the time.

5:34PM

Her eyes widen as decides to check her phone notifications, and she quickly regrets picking up the device.

Glimmer 12:45AM

we made it out okay! bow's at my place for tonight!

Glimmer 12:59AM

i forgot to tell george and lance that hes here, whoops! i'll brb!

Adora lets out a sigh of relief, despite feeling Catra glaring at her the entire time. She tries to ignore her for a brief moment, before noticing the two notifications that had her attention.

Yesterday

Catra<3 8:10PM

she-ra i left for work

Entrapta 9:02PM

I wanna run tests! Is she an android? Tell me everything!

As she reads the texts once more, Adora drops her phone onto the bed and looks quickly at her roommate. She doesn't want to think about what happened just yet. Even though only Bow and Glimmer were close enough to know about She-ra, she knew they

wouldn't say anything to Catra. Her already sore muscles tense up as she reads the texts again, and then she turns to face the short-haired woman next to her. Her eyebrows rise, and she's not sure what to do. Adora realizes she fought against her roommate, her best friend, and someone she's been in love with her entire life.

Catra explains bitterly, "Yeah, she wouldn’t stop bugging me on the way home."

Adora's eyes widen again, and she tries to speak before Catra cuts her off. The feline's voice is full of frustration, and Adora feels intimidated when she sees her baring her fangs. Catra was never the type to miss a beat, and she always made sure she could trust no one. The jock had let her guard down, and they both hadn't been honest with each other from the start. It felt sickening to watch her and know the program she was still involved in.

“Adora, it wasn't hard to miss," Catra sighs. "It’s good to know you broke our promise and lied. You barely knew these people and left!” She yells.

Catra's accusations cut deep, and Adora feels the weight of her betrayal crushing down on her. She knows she messed up, but it was for the greater good. Still, she couldn't find the words to defend herself. As Catra throws the mask at her, Adora catches it and holds it tightly in her lap. She can feel the cold metal against her skin, and it reminds her of the weight of her responsibilities. Adora takes a deep breath and tries to calm herself down, knowing that she needs to find a way to make things right with Catra. She can't lose her best friend and the person she loves the most. Adora looks up at Catra, determination in her eyes.

Now, how did I miss that for months?

Despite the pain, Adora tries to hold herself together and meet Catra's gaze. She can sense the hurt and anger in her friend's voice, and she knows that their relationship is at a breaking point. Adora's heart aches as she thinks of the lies they've told each other, but she knows that they need to work through it if they want to stay a team. She reaches out and takes Catra's hand in hers, feeling the coldness of it. It's not like the warm, comforting touch that she's used to from her friend. Catra's eyes widen at the gesture, and Adora can feel her face flushing with embarrassment.

"Catra...I never meant to hurt you," Adora says softly. "I know we've both lied to each other, but we're a team. We can work through this together."

Adora pauses for a moment, taking a deep breath before continuing. "Don't you want that too? To work together and be a team again?" she asks, looking at Catra with hope in her eyes.

Adora's heart sank at Catra's words, feeling like she had truly messed up everything between them. She watched as Catra retreated further into herself, her walls becoming impenetrable once again. Adora knew that this was going to be a difficult conversation, but she couldn't bear the thought of losing Catra as a friend. She took a deep breath and spoke softly, hoping to break through to the feline.

"I know I messed up, Catra. And I know that I can't take back what I did. But I still care about you, and I want to make things right between us. We've been through too much together to let this ruin our friendship. Can you please just talk to me and tell me how I can fix this?"

Catra's words hit Adora like a punch to the gut. She knew that Catra had been hurt by the lies and betrayal, but hearing her say that nobody cared about her and that they all hated her was like a knife through Adora's heart. She wanted to protest, to tell Catra that she was wrong, that she cared about her more than anything in the world, but the words wouldn't come. Instead, she just stood there, looking at Catra with a mixture of sadness and confusion. She wanted to help her best friend, but she didn't know how to do that when Catra seemed so closed off and angry. All she could do was stand there and hope that eventually, Catra would be willing to listen to her.

Playing hero?

Adora's voice wavers as she replies, "It's not about being better than anyone else, Catra. I didn't ask for any of this, either. And I'm sorry for leaving you behind, for not being there for you when you needed me. But I'm here now, and I want to make things right between us." Her eyes meet Catra's, and she sees the hurt and longing in them. Adora reaches out to take Catra's hand in hers, hoping to convey the sincerity of her words through the touch. "I know it won't be easy, but I want us to work through this together. Can we try?"

Adora hesitates, taking a deep breath before continuing. "I know I can't undo what I've done in the past, but I promise to be there

for you now and always. I know I may not have been the friend you needed, but I want to try and be better for you now. I love you, Catra, and I'm willing to do whatever it takes to make things right between us." Adora's voice is gentle and sincere, her eyes locked onto Catra's, hoping for a glimmer of understanding.

Catra spits out, "Save it. I know you hate me, just like everyone else." Her eyebrows furrow and Adora sees the widening of her pupils as if she is about to burst into tears. Adora reaches out to comfort her, but Catra pushes her hand away with a cold gesture. Adora can sense that Catra believes that everyone's needs are more important than her own as if this is some kind of punishment that she deserves. Despite this, Adora is determined not to give up on her and will do whatever it takes to make her see that.

“Hold on, let me just..” Adora sighs. Catra's words hit Adora hard, and she could feel her heart sink. She knew that Catra had been hurt in the past, and she didn't blame her for feeling that way. But it still hurt to hear those words from someone she cared about. Adora stays seated, not wanting to push Catra further away. She knew that she had to be patient and show her that she was different, that she truly cared. She takes a deep breath and speaks softly.

Adora turns to Catra with an earnest expression, "Catra, please believe me. I don't hate you. I actually care about you a lot, and I know I haven't been the best at showing it. But I really want to make things right between us. Will you let me try?" Despite her bandages and injuries, Adora pushes herself to get out of bed and stand on her feet. Catra watches her struggle and helps guide her arm out of the bed to help her balance. Despite feeling betrayed and scared, Catra still shows kindness to her crush. Adora gives

her a guilty look in response, not quite sure what to say. She realizes that she needs to face the day ahead - she's missed college classes and training, and her absence might have worried Hope and her best friends. As she tries to step forward, she stumbles and is caught by Catra, her enemy.

Who else would help the city?

“Adora, you need to take care of yourself first," Catra insists, gently pulling away from Adora's embrace. Adora nods, understanding the importance of self-care, but her heart aches at the thought of leaving Catra alone. She knew their relationship was complicated, but she couldn't shake off her feelings for the feline.

"I'll be back soon. We can talk more then," Adora promises, and Catra nods in agreement.

As Adora walks out of the room, she can't help but wonder if things will ever be easy between her and Catra. But she knows that she's willing to try, no matter what it takes.

I can fix this, I promise.

"Hey, I'll be okay." Adora tries to reassure her, but her tone had obvious hesitation when she spoke.

Adora attempts to reassure Catra, though her tone betrays her hesitance. She withdraws from Catra's worried touch, reaching for the bag that she had already packed with most of her clothes. Originally planning to spend the night with her two closest friends, who always understood her no matter what, Adora tries to ignore the pain that had settled in her shoulder as she slings the bag over it. She takes hold of the pen, struggling to concentrate and focus on the gravity of the situation. Her dear friend, her crush, is crying and clearly feeling betrayed, maybe even in shock. Adora looks at her with pity, worrying about what was yet to come.

“Adora,” Catra calls to her.

As Catra bites down her nervousness, Adora watches her world unravel. Despite knowing that Catra was never inherently evil, Adora struggles with the betrayal and devastation caused by Horde's actions. She tries to hold back her own tears and guilt, but she knows that no amount of honesty can change Catra's perspective. As Adora turns to leave, Catra reaches out and pleads with her to stay. However, Adora tugs her arm away and makes her way towards the door, listening to Catra's heartache. As she reaches for the doorknob, even Melog tries to stop her, biting on her ankle sock. Adora looks down at the kitten with a sad expression before pulling away and leaving the home.

"Do me a favor and watch over for me. You're in charge now." Adora whispers to the cat, and she gives her one last pat on the head.

Catra's eyes flash with anger as she turns her gaze to Adora. "And what about me? Do I deserve to be hurt? You lied to me for years, Adora."

"I know," Adora replies, her voice barely above a whisper. "I'm sorry, Catra. I never wanted to hurt you. But I had to do what was right, even if it meant hurting people I care about."

Catra snarls, her claws digging into the torn sheets. "You don't get to decide what's right for me, Adora. You don't get to play hero and leave me behind. You're not the only one who's suffered because of the Horde."

Adora takes a step back, her heart heavy with guilt and pain. "I know. I'm sorry. But I can't go back now. I have to keep fighting for what's right, for everyone's sake."

Catra's expression softens slightly, but her eyes are still filled with hurt and anger. "Then go. But don't expect me to forgive you, Adora. You hurt me too much."

Adora nods, her eyes downcast. "I understand. I'll always care about you, Catra. And I'll always be here for you if you ever need me."

Adora's heavy heart was mirrored by the chaotic scene unfolding behind her. She knew that leaving Catra was the right thing to do, but it didn't make it any easier. As she steps outside, she is greeted by the concerned faces of her two best friends. Glimmer and Bow could see the pain in Adora's eyes, but they also knew that they had to keep moving forward.

Meanwhile, inside the house, Catra's rage had reached new heights. She tore through the room, destroying everything in her path. She didn't care about the consequences or the damage she was causing. All she cared about was the betrayal she felt from Adora. How could her best friend do this to her? How could Adora choose the greater good over their friendship?

As the minutes ticked by, Catra's anger slowly began to dissipate. She was left with the overwhelming feeling of emptiness and loss. She sank to the ground, surrounded by the wreckage of her former life. She didn't know what to do next or where to go from there. All she knew was that she was alone, and it was all because of Adora.

The image falls onto the floor, and glass covers the photo in its entirety. The photo was their drawing in crayon, of the two when they were younger. Full of love, and full of promise against the world. On the back of the frame, it's written in black ink: "Together forever, happy birthday Catra!"

i promise

Chapter Summary

Catra fails to make progress, but this was a step

Chapter Notes

alcohol ment! thank u for liking this so far!!

The annual Fall Dance had arrived, a one-night event that many students looked forward to. This year's theme was "Winter's Ballad", with winter-themed decorations hanging from the ceiling and blue and white balloons everywhere. As Catra stood in the corner holding a plastic cup, she watched the other students dance and have fun. She couldn't help but feel lonely, but seeing Adora smile and blush made the night more special for her. She noticed her best friend laughing with other girls and wondered why Lonnie was with her.

"Hey Adora!" Catra called out to her and made her way over.

Adora blushes harder when Catra's hand wraps around her elbow, and she can feel the warmth radiating from her friend's body. Catra's purring makes Adora feel at ease, and she smiles at her friends who are taken aback by the sudden display of affection. Kyle and Rogelio start to say something, but Lonnie quickly cuts them off with a stern look. She knows how important Adora is to Catra, and she won't let anyone ruin their moment. Adora leans into Catra's embrace, feeling grateful to have her by her side. She knew that no matter what happened, Catra would always be there for her.

Catra laughs, trying to downplay her feelings as she says, "Don't get any ideas, Adora." But deep down, she knows that she enjoys being around the blonde more than anyone else. Adora's enthusiasm and warmth have always been a source of comfort for Catra, and the fact that they can share moments like this together fills her with a sense of contentment. As Adora takes the photo, Catra can't help but smile, feeling grateful for the memory they're creating. "Maybe we should do this more often," she suggests, feeling a rare moment of vulnerability as she admits how much she values their time together.

As Catra wakes up slowly in the silent home, she sees that it's the twentieth anniversary of when she first met Adora, and the first anniversary of when Adora left her. Despite seeing Adora on the news as She-ra, the legendary warrior who saves everyone, Catra still feels a lost crush for her. It's the only connection she has with Adora, who is now so close to her in public together. In their two years of fighting, there was always taunting and teasing, with Catra losing or escaping in bits and pieces. She knew she was the villain in everyone's story, even her own. The empty house is now only occupied by a drunken Catra and the belongings Adora didn't take with her. The bedroom has a new sheet on the mattress and torn pictures of two young girls with hope shining in their eyes for a brighter future, a simpler time when Catra could peacefully cry in her dear friend's arms.

Despite seeing Adora as She-ra on TV, the legendary warrior who saves everyone, there's a sense of disconnect between them. Catra reflects on their constant fights, always playing the villain in everyone's stories, including her own. Her bedroom is haunted by memories of the past, with a mattress, new sheets, and torn pictures of two younger girls with bright futures. She remembers

how Adora called her over to take the picture, and her arms were crossed at the homecoming dance.

Catra is unable to return to that moment, even though she wishes she could. She grips her sweater, tears up at the smile on her younger self, and uses tape to fix the torn picture. She places it close to her bed and checks her phone notifications, realizing it's been two years since Adora left her and the home they built. Despite her recklessness, Catra hasn't grown wiser from her traumas, nor is she any bolder. For the first time in so long, she feels numb and unable to cry.

No response from Adora, fuck.

As Catra scrolls through her chat with Adora, she sees a long list of "read" receipts with no response. Adora's messages were always filled with underlying aggression, but Catra knew it was only because she cared. There were times when Adora pleaded with her to leave the Horde, but Catra always brushed off her concerns. However, for the past week, Adora had gone completely silent. Catra growls in frustration as she realizes her messages had been read but ignored. Deep down, Catra was afraid of a future without Adora by her side.

Last Year
Catra 10:45AM
you did this to us.

Six Months Ago
Catra 12:05PM

seriously, adora. read it.

Last Night
Catra 1:17AM
talk to me already, traydor. (traitor)

Your number has been blocked.

Catra's frustration boils over, causing her to hurl her cell phone against the bedroom wall. The sound of ringing fills the room, but she pays it no mind as she is consumed by anger and sadness. Tears well up in her eyes as she feels the weight of her guilt and mental anguish. Despite her labored breathing and heavy heart, she refuses to show weakness. This is her new normal, a life filled with emptiness and self-destruction.

"Whatever," she mutters to herself, knowing there is no one to listen. Catra is now a shell of her former self, her once-fiery heart now reduced to rubble. Adora was the only thing that ever brought her comfort, but now she can only gaze at the hero from a distance, knowing that they will never be together again. As she tries to wipe away her tears, Catra realizes that this bedroom, once a sanctuary, is now cluttered with Adora's belongings, making it feel even more suffocating.

I don't want to think about it anymore.

Catra longs to numb her pain with alcohol, hoping to find some solace or enjoyment before inevitably vomiting. As a young villain, she relished in the thrill of stealing, even stealing whiskey. But even that couldn't fill the void of Adora's absence. Retrieving a full

bottle from under her bed, Catra takes a few swigs, the taste unpleasant but the escape invaluable. She had given up on consistent meals and sleep schedules, her life now in disarray of chaos. As the alcohol hits harder, she succumbs to dizziness, but she no longer fights the feeling. Who cares anyway? Does she even care? With a cracked phone and a mind in disarray, Catra feels alone, but she reminds herself that Adora is no longer there to judge her.

The phone beeped, signaling a voicemail, but Catra was too drunk to care. She didn't even notice Melog pawing at the door and howling outside, trying to offer comfort. Her voice was still hoarse from sobbing earlier, and her breath felt like fire in her throat. Her world felt cold and lonely as she lay in bed, while the rest of the world burned without her. Catra had always been guarded, but at that moment, she was vulnerable and alone, with only her emotional pain as a company. When she was alone, she often invited her demons to a drunken pity party.

"Damn it, Adora. I can't even love you. I'm your enemy... did any of it mean anything to you? Did I mean anything to you?" Catra questions.

Her chest constricts and she struggles to take a deep breath as tears stream down her face and fall onto the bottle. Catra hisses with a mix of anger and longing, feeling disgusted in her own skin. She wishes she could claw herself apart. At this moment, she is torn between her head and her heart, but all she really wants is someone to talk to. She feels dizzy as she leans back against the bed. It's been weeks since she's had any company in the home they were supposed to build together. Were they supposed to build it together? Maybe it was just her. Was Adora even

interested in women? Catra reaches for the bottle, hoping it's already been refilled.

"Ugh. Who am I kidding? I never stopped loving you. Just come back already. You're supposed to be mine."

Catra runs her black claw along the whiskey bottle before picking it up and examining the liquid inside. She watches as the alcohol sways in the glass, then glares at the mask beside her. She grabs the headpiece and places it on her head, causing her appearance to shift into her feline form. She takes the headpiece off and puts it back on again, the changes becoming more apparent each time. Catra pushes the bottle off her bed, and it shatters on the floor, causing her to purr at the thought of danger.

As she looks down at the broken glass and spilled alcohol, she thinks about how Melog misses Adora. Catra's pupils dilate, her tail flicks, and her ears go back as she feels the pang of loneliness.

Sinungaling ako. (I lied)

The feline woman bursts into laughter, snorting as she lies on her side. Catra feels sick and tries to balance out the feeling in her stomach by getting up. Stumbling, her tail curls weakly around her abdomen as she reaches for the second bottle. The pain of glass stabbing her feet is numbed out by the dizziness flaring all over her body. Her face is red, and she's an obviously drunken mess. Her heart pounds in her chest as the static of the phone fills her ears with dread. She leans down and covers her black

ears, screaming at an empty room. This home feels sickening, torturous even.

“Stop being so fucking weak!" she screams into the emptiness.

Catra feels bitter to the core, the mere thought of talking about her feelings makes her cringe. She's angry, scared, and utterly alone. Her legs tense, and her fur stands on end. Her heart races as she feels the glass shards pushing through the soles of her feet. She rises to her feet and slowly makes her way to the door, with Melog waiting patiently beside her. When she reaches the door, she scoops up her gentle friend with one hand and spills the alcohol around the bedroom with the other. She stares at the pictures of her and Adora and the few belongings Adora left behind. After finishing the bottle, she hurls it into the room. The huntress is over it. She's frustrated, exhausted, and knows she'll regret it. Her cat watches, ears flattened, as the mess in the room grows.

She lets out a heavy sigh, realizing that there is no turning back now. The lighter in her pocket flares to life, and she throws it into the alcohol-soaked room. She purrs louder as she watches the flame grow, consuming the pictures and memories they built together. A smirk spreads across her face as she sprints away with Melog, leaving the home and the ghosts of her past behind. The lump in her throat grows heavier. Was this what she wanted? No, but did it make things worse? Yes.

"Fuck!" She screams out in frustration and despair.

The huntress sobs once more, overwhelmed by the fear of never being able to go back and the daunting prospect of moving forward. The very idea of existence feels like an insurmountable challenge, and the thought of ending it all becomes a tempting option. She feels like nothing but a pawn in a larger system that kept her and Adora apart. Adora was everything to her, and the system that kept them apart was the only thing that mattered.

Falling to her knees, Catra clutches her arms and shakes as she takes in the coldness of the air. Her bedroom may be on fire, but the world feels even colder. Her cat's purring against her leg reminds her of the present, and the snow on the ground prickles at her fur. She removes her helmet, but her appearance remains unchanged. She has accepted who she is and opens the door to her true self. She sobs into the snow as she contemplates her existence, but her headache distracts her from her thoughts. She wonders who she is without Adora and realizes that she can be more than just a Force Captain without her. She hobbles away from the burning house, with the glass still embedded in her feet, and asks herself, "Who is Adora without me?"

And then, she declares to herself, "I'm Catra."

pitiful party

Chapter Summary

adora and glimmer host a party, and it gets crashed. this is also nsfw

Chapter Notes

lots of this series has been rewritten to be slightly more show accurate

The morning sunrise falls east, and west, of her temporary home, until she can move into a better place, at a different location. Her bare feet pressed against the bare floorboard, in her second-floor bedroom patio. This place Adora has settled down this past month is her domain to roam upon. She could escape her issues this way, to live here freely without anyone to find her. The athlete leans her elbows upon the metal railing, and she grips onto her mug of hot chocolate. With cold weather surrounding her, a small breeze combs through her ponytail, and she takes two sips.

Adora inhales through her suddenly redden nose, and she exhales the stabbing temperatures from her lungs. She's mesmerized at the view of everyone having fun or the frost escaping her mouth, there were no clouds but for left-over snow at sunrise, and the sunrise climbing into the horizon. Her tranquil moment gets interrupted by the sound of children playing in the snow. Giggles fill the air as the sound of feet crushing into the snow where children shriek at snowballs being thrown. Adora longs for innocence such as this and she longs for Catra to be at her side again.

“Adora!” Glimmer calls out excitedly.

The excitement is just too early in the morning, but these are the few little things that Adora's grateful for. She walks towards the smaller of the two, and she shuts the patio door behind her as she turns her head to face her true best friend. Adora takes another sip of her drink as she raises an eyebrow in response to Glimmer. She's always been a morning person, but that day was the only time she could take a break from training and settle down with partial relaxation. But the excitement Glimmer had was never an option the blonde wanted to pass.

“We're hosting the Christmas party tonight!” Glimmer yells excitedly as her eyes glistened when she jumps with joy.

“The Christmas party. Riiiight..?” Adora questioned.

“You've hosted a party before, right?” Glimmer deadpans.

“Not at all.” Adora laughs nervously.

Glimmer sharply inhales a sigh through her nose, out of pure annoyance. Adora picks up that the pink-haired girl isn't having any of it. Adora laughs nervously as she pulls a loose hair behind her ear. She looks down at the shorter of the two awkwardly, giving her a genuine smile and a curious look. She hasn't been to any celebrations or let alone hosted one, where she was from she had to earn it through hard work. She did perfectly fine in them, but no one else did, so there was never a party.

“It's nothing too exciting? But it's really fun to get with your friends for the holidays!” Glimmer adds.

“A party! Because I totally know how to host one, obviously.” Adora shrugs.

Besides tries to downplay it and laugh it off. It's been so long since she's done anything else besides college work, saving the city, and training in her daily routine. As much as she does get out and talk to people happily, the idea of a party on her one day off seemed all too overwhelming. She couldn't understand why it felt that way, but it could be caused by a particular feline-like woman who sought out her attention in the worst way possible.

“I texted the chat about it!” Glimmer cheers.

Oh my god. No, no, no.

“Glimmer. That doesn’t happen to be the old chat with *Catra*, right?” Adora alerts her.

Glimmer doesn’t answer, but her embarrassed expression tells Adora everything. Adora sighs out of frustration and she tosses her cellphone onto her bed. The blonde jumps onto her bed, and she grabs the phone to check the notification. She screams frustration into the pillow, and the blonde asks if Catra had spoken in that chat. Glimmer looks down at her, guilt-ridden from her

honest mistake. She hands the cellphone over to Adora, and the jock reads the chat on the screen. If she couldn't be more damned already.

(ignore) catra 8:32AM

god no. also it's like 5 in the morning shut up!

(ignore) catra 8:36AM

oh, a party? on second thought, ill go <3

Adora reread the last sentence sent. Their last encounter together wasn't necessarily perfect since the feline had gotten more ruthless and tactile with the blonde. She couldn't imagine how that would work together at a party, let alone on her vacation, in a house full of people that didn't even trust her when they first met her instantly. She sighs.

"That's *great*." Adora groans.

Glimmer lifts her hand and she rubs the blonde's shoulder in an attempt to comfort her the best way she could. It was complicated between all of them, and she knew the guilt of texting the wrong chat was eating at her slowly. She felt bad for her but she knew it would only be a bad time to overly apologize to her friend.

“Come on, she’s *probably* bluffing... hopefully.” Glimmer smiles.

If only that were true, Catra is just so unpredictable. It made Adora’s skin crawl at the thought of her ex-friend showing up as anyone's date. Neither of them identified with liking men, so the mere thought of Catra showing up with anyone or in general makes the jock upset. She still harbored unresolved feelings and had clear tension whenever Catra is mentioned or in the same vicinity as her. Adora gets up, and she thanked Glimmer for at least trying. She knew Glimmer tries her best to make sure her friends are okay, and that made Adora smile. When the shorter girl walks out and shuts the door, the blonde makes way to the closet to get dressed. She thought for a moment about being She-ra for the event, but she shouldn't draw attention to herself. Everyone knew loved She-ra, but she knows the one person she loves doesn't.

She finds her dark red dress with the golden lace around the waist, and she removes her robes to slip inside of the outfit. The warrior doesn’t know how to do her own hair, so she decides it was best to put it up with her little golden clip. She watches herself in the mirror with dissatisfaction. The clawed scar on her face is visible, and it showed signs a feline had clawed at her. She studies the five marks that trailed under her eye and to the bottom of her jaw. She knew she was going to be a disaster, maybe turning into the eight-foot-tall warrior in the ponytail could be a better idea.

“*Shit*.” Adora groans.

The first floor of the quiet home became filled with guests who are all too familiar. There were people in formal outfits, holding wine glasses. Most of the guests were either older people or those around her age. Adora listened to the Spotify playlist from the speaker as strangers tried to speak to her. She stayed as the eight-foot-tall woman and listened to comments about how She-ra was their hero, about Glimmer's mom, and general nonsense she rarely paid attention to. She kept staring at the door waiting for Catra to ruin the event. Just more guests, and no grand entrance from her enemy.

"Hey, I'm gonna get another glass. I'll be right back." Adora interrupted the others speaking.

♪ I remember when I first noticed that you liked me back .. ♪

Adora leaves as she studies everyone walking by, and she notices Glimmer talking to Bow while Perfuma left the group as she clung onto Scorpia's pincer. Good for those two, and good for Glimmer and Bow. Nothing new in her world, it was just guests and friends mingling but there was no sign of Catra. Adora swallowed down the shot, and her head felt fine at the moment. It wasn't necessarily common for her to drink alcohol unless it was *that* bad. Adora was the type of person to claim there were more important things to take than alcohol, but it seemed that was the only thing in her mind that she can temporarily put attention into. As she stares at the door once again, Mermista gets in front of her.

“Etheria City to She-ra, hello??” Mermista’s tone is her usually annoyed voice.

"Oh my god, hey!" Adora smiles, her cheeks starting to flush from the shot.

Adora turns to look down at her and Mermista blushes in surprise at how attractive She-ra was. The scars on her cheek only made her more visually appealing to the mermaid. She admired a lot about She-ra, especially the aesthetic appeal the blonde had. Mermista looks away as she spoke, not trying to give too much attention to herself. Her boyfriend was across the house stealing what food he could, and it was distracting enough for her not to babysit him. The two begin to talk, and Mermista crosses her arms as she laughs gently. The blonde smiles at her, and she seemingly laughs in response.

Mermista's so pretty.

♪ .. But I could tell that something had changed how you looked at me then ♪

On the spot, Adora noticed a particular feline entering the room without her mask. Her hair was cut down to a pixie-cut, her tuxedo was maroon colored and red, with no indication of shoes. Catra immediately looked over at Adora with a dirty look, before heading towards Scorpia who was spending time with Perfuma. Adora reaches out and holds Mermista’s hip, and her laugh suddenly became slightly *forced.* Her own voice seemed to sound soothing, if anything, the poor blonde voice cracked in front of

her. Mermista looked at her questioningly, and she didn’t seem to mind it too much. Adora glanced at Catra again, who looked back at her harshly. Her eyes shrieked sadness when her arms crossed and her ears went down. She seemed sadder than anything else and her eyes showed a soft baby-blue and yellow. She's exactly who the blonde yearns for.

“Wow, *what* are you trying to do? You're *not slick*. But... it's not like I mind.” Mermista asks.

“I don't know...” Adora answers.

Catra laughs with the group she's in but seeing Adora like that with someone else hurt her so much more than her leaving. The feline studies Adora's body movements, and how flushed her face was when she talked to the other. She wasn't used to it, and she hated every second of it. She began to dig her black claws into her gloves, which broke and she dug into her own skin. How dare she leave and do this? Why does it keep coming back to Adora? Her heart races slightly, and she tries to calm herself down. She misses her.

♪ I like you best when you're just with me and no one else ♪

Sea Hawk made another mess, which frustrated his date. Mermista calls at him, she walks in his direction while sighing. Adora breathed out as her stomach felt off, she makes way to get another drink. She hasn’t realized her chest has been tight the entire night, and that her palms were sweaty. She felt sick but it

was either the alcohol or the sight of Catra that kept throwing her off tonight. She longed for her but she couldn't just say that out loud. She looks at the feline.

I need to let go.

Adora makes her way back to the table that carried the drinks. She picks a few cups to down what she can due to how much of an impulsive young adult she can be. The taste is sour, it leaves a bitter taste in her mouth, worse than how it made her feel. Her head became slightly dizzy at the few sips she had. Her vision started to become impaired, and her eyes were glossy.

"Hey, Adora." Catra greeted cynically.

Leave me alone.

"I saw *your girlfriend* walk out on you." Catra snickered, leaning her hand on the table.

Adora glared at her angrily as her face became red. Her eyes squinted and she rolled them at her comment.

"Shouldn't you have one? Sounds like you went here alone." Adora scoffs.

The feline's ear twitched, and her tail flicked in sudden annoyance. She did nothing to her. Not yet, anyway.

♪ Kristen, come right back, I've been waiting for you to slip back in bed ♪

"I'd rather be alone than abandoned like that. But only *you would know*." Catra retaliates.

Catra grabs Adora's drink from her hand and she downs the rest of it herself before dropping it purposely and wiping her mouth with her coat sleeve. She smirked, hiding her sadness and rage behind her face. Adora catches her own eyebrows arching. Within a second, she grabs Catra by the collar and drags her upstairs to her bedroom. As they get inside, she locks the door, and she shoves the feline suddenly. The party becomes muffled background through the walls, and Catra looks up at her when she lands on the floor. She sees the feline ache in pain, and she decides to transform into herself again.

"Why did you show up here? Why did you leave me that voicemail yesterday?" Adora questions her as she tries to hold back her anger.

Catra looks at her weirdly, but she stays down instead. She snarls to bare her teeth for the warrior to see. None of this was playful teasing anymore, maybe when she still hid her identity as Force Captain. She didn't care anymore about the isolation, being betrayed, and being abandoned. This was war, and she didn't care

about getting personal anymore. It always was to her. More than just a game.

“I didn’t call you, Adora. I don't even like you.” Catra hisses.

She gets back onto her feet before Adora pushes her down again. Catra’s defensive, but Adora knew better than that. Her chest feels heavy, and she felt the sudden rush of adrenaline inside of her. She tries not to react so much as she wants to. Not in her new home, and not in her own room. Adora sighs unhappily as she sits on her waist to make sure she didn't get up. The blonde didn't want her escaping at such a time as this. The feline blushed as she looked up at her, and her pupils widen at the sight. Adora takes out her phone, and she plays the voicemail that ended with a burning noise before it hangs up.

Catra’s eyes widen, realizing all of the mumbled bullshit she said the other day was after she tossed her phone against the wall, and it probably called Adora unintentionally. There‘s no point in defending herself or changing topics, she‘s cornered in a bedroom, and her lightweight body is drunk. She looks away from her instead, and a physical shade of red paints her cheeks. She couldn't get more cowardly than this.

“What about it? Tanga, it’s whatever, it doesn’t mean I like you, *at all.* Besides, you have your date, your best friend Lonnie, or even Sparkles.” Catra's tail flicks.

Adora’s eyes widen at the peculiar comment, it seems really out of nowhere. Was Catra *that* upset?

“Glimmer's my best friend, and Mermista has a boyfriend. I haven't talked even talked to Lonnie in ages.” Adora snickers.

“I.. I don't like you.” Catra scowls.

Wow, she's probably drunk. Am I? What were we even talking about? Did she not know what to say?

“...Suuuuuure,” Adora responds.

Adora looks down at her with a blush, and she realizes what position they're in. She barely even recognized that Catra cut her hair down, did she do it out of breakdown? The blonde watches her eyes, and they're wide. Do cats always do that? She snorts laughs when she realizes their situation. Catra looks up at her awkwardly, and her hands hold onto the blonde's hip. They're both awkward together, but it feels natural between the two. Together.

“I’m so fucking.. drunk.” Adora snorts.

“This is... is a thing for future Adora and Catra to worry about.” Catra purrs, her head falling back.

♪ And I'm kissing you lying in my room ♪

Their faces met as the both of them rested their foreheads upon one another until their lips pressed together. Catra grunts excitedly as she tugs onto the blonde‘s bottom lip with her feline teeth. Adora pulls away slightly, her bottom lip being tugged with the kiss. Was the feeling *only* alcohol? Adora wanted to kiss her again, she was a mess when it came to her dear ... friend. The blonde's chest burns warm, and her hips began to carry sudden urges. She starts to dig her hips into the feline’s torso, and she made sure to lock the both of them into the carpet. She accidentally hits Catra’s head with hers as she kisses her drunkenly, their teeth caught one another as Adora’s tongue slips into Catra’s mouth. The feline purrs harder, and she pulls down the zipper to Adora’s red dress.

The taller girl inhales sharply as she rips Catra’s coat off of her, and she starts to unbutton her maroon top. In between kisses, Adora squeezes around the feline woman’s chest, followed by whimpers escaping from Catra mouth. Adora breaks away from the kiss momentarily. She gently tugs onto her short curly hair and traces her own teeth against Catra's neck then to her jaw. Adora craves her, just as much as Catra is.

Catra begins to growl softly, and she grinds her hips against Adoras', willing to get any sort of touch from her. Her gaze follows Adora’s face in her drunken eyes and she felt like she was home, at peace. She sighs softly as the blonde nicks are her sensitive spot. She puts emphasis on touch as she guides Adora's hand to move between the feline's thighs. Adora moves her hand, and Catra holds onto her as she gets slightly louder.

♪ And it's just as good as I knew it would be ♪

The duo together again, with a raw tenderness that no one would understand. Adora wasn't She-ra, and Catra remained true to herself. Catra admires the beauty above her, and she couldn't think of anything - anyone else than who she fell in love with. But the feeling fades when she realizes it's temporary, and it'll be back to how they were. Enemies. Her hips buck when Adora moves quicker, and her gaze falls on the scars she left on Adora's face or the ones she left on her back. She felt sick, like a monster that no one but Weaver wanted her to be. She panics and backs away when the image of Adora comes back to her. She-ra wounded, just two years ago. They couldn't be together. Adora speaks up to try and get her attention as she notices the pause from the other woman.

“Catra..?” Adora calls to her.

Catra clutches onto her tightly, and she’s whining loudly. It’s the effects of war, of torment she created since that day. A day she can never forgive herself for, so she doesn’t speak. She’s too drunk to muster words, but Adora tries to hold onto her regardless. She keeps her in her arms, and murmurs into her ear. Adora whispers familiar reassurances she used to give to Catra when they were at the abusive institution. They were the abuse survivors of Weaver’s error. Catra closes her eyes, and her ear flicks to Adora’s sweet whispers that calms down the blood-driven feline.

"*Don’t* go." Catra whispers to her.

"I'm not going anywhere.. it'll be okay," Adora reassures her.

"You promise?" She clings to the blonde.

Adora knew they were both too drunk, too vulnerable. She knew she had made the mistake of drinking past her limit or allowing Catra to drink herself. The blonde starts to tear up with her, and she then presses her lips to Catra’s cheek as reassurance. Her grip gets tighter, and she never wanted to do this again. She was warm, and she was her everything. She never wanted to leave her, no matter what happened to the both of them.

"I promise," Adora whispers.

♪ Stay with me I don't want you to leave ♪
♪ Kristen, come right back ♪
♪ I've been waiting for you to slip back in bed ♪
♪ When you light the candle ♪

the after party

Chapter Summary

Hordak takes matters into his own hands. Catra reconciles with Adora.

Chapter Notes

happy new years! theres a few trauma stuff with shadow weaver and catra

edit: fanfic was rewritten in 2021 finally

Clouds and miss fill the darkness outside of the home, with a particular glowing neon red staring at the bedroom window of the two girls who slept together. Two traitors, with a barely serviceable second command at his side. The large figure resembled the one of an older gentleman, whose ambiguous figure shows trouble. His back leans onto his vehicle, and he stares up to notice the two petite figures go into the side of the bedroom. He then glances directly at the escort next to him, Weaver. Hordak pulls the woman in front of him, and he keeps direct eye contact with her. His navy-blue suit gets stained by the incoming rain.

“Make sure they don’t leave your sight. I will be in contact with Prime soon enough. I'm going to work at the lab with Entrapta, do not let me down.” Hordak commands.

The wicked woman looks at him with a sinister smile in response. Her scarred face, green eyes, and unkempt hair were enough to traumatize a child on sight. Hordak raises an eyebrow at her before he got into the driver's side of his vehicle. He looked back at the window of the two women before he realized what was

happening. In respect, he looked back to Weaver who only seemed interested in plotting while looking at the pavement to construct her devilish plan. Revenge. Hatred against a particular feline who had taken her golden child away, who took command and destroyed her mask.

“As you wish, Lord Hordak,” Weaver responds.

In an instant, she flashes a shadow under the house door. The older gentleman glanced at her one last time before taking his car to drive off from the neighborhood, in order to keep his presence masked. Truly, a neighborhood like this was too much for him. Weaver stayed behind before plotting a way to harass the two former mistakes of hers in the morning.

Dark-colored clouds surround the daytime sky. There was a storm that could break at any second but for right now the clouds remained at bay. The bedroom remained silent, with only gentle breathing and a bed sheet where the two girls slept peacefully from the night before. Rain began to pour against the window next to the bed, placing gentle taps on the glass before they gradually slam harder on the window. Adora groans slightly, and she moves to her side as she wraps her arm around Catra. Her ear twitches at the aggressive raindrops, but she ignores them for a well-needed rest. The rain gets louder, and she slowly begins to open her eyes. Catra’s vision is blurry at first, but she shifts to her side and finds herself in Adora's arms. She moves back slightly but tries not to make any noise. Her headache settles in, and the soreness between her thighs became evident.

Banal na tae. Magkantot. (Holy shit. Fuck.)

Catra breathes slowly to not provoke herself. She was in shock she did this with *Adora,* she begins to look down at her body, then she gets a sudden sore feeling on her neck. Her worries became too true, and she places the sheets back onto her body. Her ear flicks she uses the silence of the home to her advantage, there was no one left but the two of them in the bedroom. Her ear twitched again, there was only rain and soon-to-be thunder. She faces Adora, who was gently asleep in bed. She lightly taps her shoulder with no response.

“Psst, Adora.” Catra murmurs to her.

There was only a grumble and groan from the other. It annoyed the feline as much as it annoyed Adora waking up with such a bad hangover from the night before. The blonde slowly opens her eyes and she soon sees Catra in front of her face. She starts screaming at first, then she moved back until she fell off her own bed. Catra makes a stern face before laughing at the girl who fell off. She’s an oblivious dork, and that still appealed to Catra.

“I thought you went home last night!” Adora screams frantically as she tries to find her pen.

“Obviously not! I don't even have a home.” Catra squints at her.

"Wait, what?" Adora looks at her, confused.

"Nothing." Catra tries to change the topic.

Catra pulls the white blanket down from her body and points at the large bruise that Adora had left on her the night before. She watches Adora's face turn to a bright red, and she noticed her own cheeks flushing lightly. She bit down on her own tongue. Who knew that would leave the both of them flustered, in a sticky situation like this? She shouldn't have gone to that party, but it's not like she regretted it.

Holy shit my breath reeks.

"What are you gonna do, kick me out? Tell on me?" Catra taunts and laughs before the clap of thunder stuns her.

When growing up in the Fright Zone, she never really had the opportunity of being comforted unless it was by Adora. Or maybe by her real mother if she could think back harder. That was the only sort of coping mechanism she can hold onto in those two years. Storms have always terrified the feline even before she was let into the Horde. It always stormed on the islands of the Philippines, and her only mother was there to comfort her. She recognized how the rain would drench her, and how the loud thunder felt overwhelming. The thought of it was so long ago, with fragments to remember her by.

Hesukristo! (Jesus!)

Adora gets back on the bed as she leans over and comforts Catra like muscle memory. Her hands are playing with the feline's hair, and she's cradled instinctively by the other. Catra's eyes and pupils widen as she looks at her. Her face was full of shock as she watches her, and she can feel the uncontrollable purring escape her throat. The blonde realizes what she's doing, and she slowly stops. The feline whines at the loss of touch.

“Jeez, Adora.” Catra groans as she picks up the other phone.

“Are you okay?” Adora asks her.

“You big dummy. What does it look like? There’s no service.” Catra sighs.

"I'll ask Glimmer," Adora says.

“There’s no one in the house. I listened while you were sleeping.” Catra scratches her head in utter irritation.

The storm gained more strength, and the rain started to fly with the wind. Catra looks out Adora’s window and closes the blinds rather too quickly. Her paranoia grew when she heard whispers, and she tries to ignore them. It was probably nothing, it gets to the best of her sometimes. Especially when her mind goes to dark places when she thinks about the storm.

“Right no service, right.. okay, well, I have a pair of clothes at the end of the bed.” Adora points at the red t-shirt and gray joggers.

Catra hisses immediately, and she throws Adora’s pillow at her. The blonde makes a noise as the pillow hits her face.

“I am *not* wearing that!” Catra growled.

“Quit acting like a big baby!” Adora gets to her feet and shoves the pillow back into the girl.

Adora chuckles softly, and it made Catra flustered. The feline hisses again, and she rushes to the clothes offered to her. The first thing she did was claw at the top to make it into a cropped tank top, and she puts the joggers on easily. It made her blush to wear her clothes, even if it wasn't the most romantic thing in her life.

She's gonna kill me ... nice.

The blonde goes down the stairs and into the kitchen while Catra had the impulsive need to follow her even though they have radio silence. The jock makes her way past the table, and to the fridge to grab a carton of eggs and some vegetables. She grabs the pan and prepares breakfast for both of them. Catra was just going to

be an asshole and watch from the table instead of helping, it wasn’t her house anyway.

The feline sighs and she just watches her. She misses her without needing to admit it, deep down she missed what they used to do every day. Catra would watch her cook, then admire how determined she was. She remembers how she helped Adora in the kitchen, she remembered Adora tried to help her prepare traditional Filipino dishes for her birthday. She remembers how they both didn’t get it right. She remembers how no one else showed up but Adora. Catra grunts in annoyance. Culture is stolen from her. A life she didn't get to live if she never joined the Horde. If they didn't steal kids.

Catra avoids her thoughts when she sees Adora wince out when she cuts her hand with the kitchen knife. Catra gets up quickly, and she gets a towel for her. She paces around trying to look for the medicine cabinet. Once she finds the Neosporin and bandages, she makes her way to Adora who waited by the sink. Catra sprays at the wound then she wraps it with bandaging. The thunder rages on and the power cuts off in the neighborhood.

“Are you alright?” Catra asks.

“Now that you're here.” Adora smiles.

“Don’t say that. *Don’t*.” The feline gives a kiss on the blonde girl’s palm, and she hugs her for a moment.

Adora hugs her back, and she rests her chin on top of the shorter girl's head. Catra purrs a little before she breaks the affection to grab the plates and make her way to the oven to grab the two meals sizzling. The blonde didn't even need to make any of it, but regardless Catra was thankful. She didn't want to break the hug from Adora, but she was starving.

They both make their way to the table and they sit across from each other. Catra hasn't been eating well since the week after Adora moved out. She looks down at the plate, grabs her fork and knife, then tries to eat what she could. She forgot how to take care of herself, and karma was a bitch who happens to be the best at Catra's worst.

Adora just watches her. Catra couldn't tell if the jock was either intimidated or worried, she shared both expressions equally. It put Catra off only slightly, but she just consumes what she can before downing as much water as she could take. She looks at Adora, and the poor girl already finished her plate. It wasn't amusing to her, but she swore she could hear a small giggle escape from her. But cute meant pathetic, right? Silence falls on both of them until Adora decides to open her mouth.

"We can't keep avoiding it, we need to talk about She-ra. We need to talk about you. We need to talk about us." Adora concerned.

"Drop me off in the desert, and I'll get out of your way. No one wants me." Catra cowers.

"Own up to what you did and do it *right*," Adora yells in annoyance.

Catra's biggest fear of death itself was commitment. Staying true to her word, and admitting that she was wrong. She lost the commitment from the person who became her absolute world the second she carried that awful sword. Her chest tightened, and she tries to exhale the pain away. Her chest felt like forced glass pushed together from shards. She doesn't answer her, she doesn't feel ready to admit that she's committed such atrocities to both of them. However, her gaze goes back to Adora's speaks volumes. It was like Adora *already* knew. Catra gets up and pulls her from the chair. She leans into her touch and she holds her.

Her intrusive thoughts played in her head:

She left for a reason child. Did you really think you meant anything to her? You're her pet, a weak kitten who was the pesky runt in her litter. You're nothing to her and the blood that comes is ***your fault.***

Her erratic breathing intensifies, and she grips Adora's hand as she winces at the sharp pain pushing into her injury. Reality sets her, and she lets the poor blonde's hand go. She looks at her, and then the thunder from earlier claps louder with her harsh breaths.

"I can't escape, no matter how hard I try, I can't do it right." Catra panics. She felt like a child again.

"What do you mean?" Adora asks as she holds her.

"I'm sorry, for everything!" Catra sobs into her shoulder.

Lightning flashes through the windows of the living room, followed by the home shaking with each clap. She closes her eyes, and the storm comes back to her hauntingly. The fights in the city, the times when Weaver taunts her during the day, pushing away her team, and the intense fights she's had with everyone that nearly broke her.

Catra's sobbing and she doesn't let go of the comfort of her arms. She doesn't move her face away, and her breathing intensifies with each passing moment. With the passing memories, with each abandonment, with each haunting second with Adora. Her chest felt stiff. It was broken cement blocks after an earthquake and its head's pounding.

"Catra, we'll figure it out together," Adora reassures her.

Adora really is someone who looked after her every day from school, or when she had a tough time that no child goes through. She felt arms wrap around her, and she sees candlelight being lit from nowhere. She closes her eyes and she's shivering uncontrollably. She was weak. The feline was tempted to drink off her feelings, but she didn't want to feel far gone from herself.

Catra's head's stroked, and it's by Adora's hands. She begins to rest her head on her shoulder. She doesn't say anything but the feline knew this feeling, the same feeling as when she was at the

party. Adora’s breathing is too soothing, it was the relief she needed for her issues.

“We love each other, we can get through it," Adora whispers to her.

Catra shakes her head, she doesn’t want to think about how they got so far too quickly. She knows they're fixing it now, even if her insecurities are hanging her on a tightrope. The feline wraps her arms around the girl, and she shares the blanket that was on the couch. She guides Adora once more, and they sit together comfortably. They're holding each other, and that's what matters.

As the storm rages on, she’s at the calmest past and present with the girl she loves. She keeps her head rested, and her body starts to feel warm. Her eyes close slowly, and her problems are lifted away with her breathing. Catra drifts off to sleep, knowing that they’ll both be together when she awakens.

Two hours had passed and Adora doesn’t wake up the sleeping girl, and she carries her to the bed she has. She tries to keep her eyes open but her wits don’t allow her as her eyes start to close again. She lays in the bed with her, and she inhales the scent of the other. She wants her.

together alone

Chapter Summary

catra faces her nightmares and she tries to change, but it never felt enough for the both of them

Chapter Notes

rewritten 2021

There were two shadows that followed the terrified young feline into her bunkbed. She sobbed, shivering even at the sight of the red lightning that was in pursuit of her. She stared at the figures who shaped out to be a younger blonde and a masked woman who gave her the coldest stare she had ever felt. The young feline didn't understand the woman who petted her head, before dragging her hair to make her stand up. Immediately Adora ages to her pre-teen self as the eight-year-old feline stares at her. She's intimidated, perplexed at the sudden change. Her little hand reaches out for the blonde, then suddenly she finds herself about the same age as Adora, and they're on the neon-pink training platform.

"Catch up!" Adora laughs as she swings the staff.

What?

Catra smirks at her, and she lunges upward with her own weapon. They spar with the clash of their staffs. The feline jumps high in an attempt to land on Adora, but instead, she falls onto the rooftop of the Fright Zone, where Adora sat with her in the sunset. Her ears flick as she lands on the metal roofing. She

watches the sun go down as she sits with her dearest friend, her world. She smiles at her, and her hand falls onto the lap of the blonde.

"Hey... I'm leaving tomorrow, they said that they found my godmother. I'm going home." Adora announces as she smiles sadly at her.

"But you *just* got your promotion! What about *our* plans?" Catra questions frantically.

Fuck, why am I here? Why is this happening?

Adora holds her hands with both of Catras'. She guides the feline's hands to her face, and she leans into her touch. The sunset rests on Adora's face, and her crystal eyes look mesmerizing to the feline. She was hers, and her heart yearned for her. As she leans into Adora's face, the feline watches Adora slowly fade out in front of her as her two hands press on She-ra's face, and her environment turns into the night-time city with the broken street under her. She's panicking as she watches Adora's face bleed against her hands.

"Adora!" Catra calls out to her, but there's no response.

Clouds form around both of them and she watches the familiar red lightning reappear through the dark mist. It surrounds her vision, and all she can see is darkness. She's on her knees, and

she's screaming out for help, but there was no response. She begged whoever it was to stop, and she sees the fallen warrior disappear out of her sight. She got up from the floor, with her face still bleeding from that fight. Catra paces around, with nothing besides her but darkness.

The feline runs forward and runs into what she felt like a wall, her hands scratch into the black walls and she attempted to claw it open. Nothing happened from it, and she turns around to see her real mother staring at her. Her figure was tall, and her long black hair with yellow eyes of the coldest stare only looks her direction, but not at her. She wore a white nightgown as her face pooled with blood down to her neck and her knees. She wore the sun of the Filipino flag on her neck. Her trembling hand reaches for her. Her pupils widen at the sight of her. She missed her.

Nanay..? (Mom..?)

Catra notices a round black ball roll to her feet. She leans down to pick it up curiously as she notices the large 8 on it, and her tail twitches as she shakes the object in questioning. There was nothing to appear other than a blue light on the orb. The light had no words, so she shakes it again as none of the options had colors. She turns it to the top of the 8, and she clears her throat to speak.

"Why did you give me away? Why are you doing this, did I deserve this?" Catra questions as she sobs.

She shakes the orb and the option turns into words with white lettering. She couldn't read it out as it was glitched, gibberish. Catra shakes the orb again before the blue turns into a red color, with an eye-straining blue text saying **"WITHOUT A DOUBT**", the black orb melts in her hands. and she screams out as the sensation burns her hands. The feline throws the object the best she could, and she looks at the woman who only blankly stares at her.

The woman had no name, and she certainly was no one even significantly interesting to anyone else but Catra. The sun on her neck lights up, and her body catches on fire as the environment changes to the house she owned with Adora. Catra was on her knees and she looked up at the house burning, and her mother looking at her through the window of the home. The feline watches her burn everything, and she's stunned as her pupils close tightly. She holds herself as she faceplants into the snow, and she sobs her heart out. It was cold, and the snow fell on her continually. She didn't feel the shards of glass in her feet, even if she could see them. The sweater wasn't enough to keep the cold away.

"Stop!" She yells loudly, but she's alone.

Her environment changes to her back inside the Fright Zone, where she's standing in front of the mirror where she was sobbing her heart out and she had just finished chopping her hair down to a pixie. She's wearing her Horde crop top and shorts, and her tail waved as she looked at herself in disgust. Catra jumps backward, and she feels someone catch her from behind. She turns slowly to herself and the broken fragments of her own face. There was nothing behind their left eye besides shards, and darkness. The feline backs into the sink upon sight of herself.

"*Ohhhh nooo,* is someone a little shocked?" The other asks hauntingly.

"What.. what are you doing? Stop, stop." Catra begs as she covers her ears.

Catra falls into the bathroom floor as she looks at the others in horror. The other laughs hysterically, and they simply walk forward in front of the terrified woman who was helpless. She couldn't do anything, and she didn't know what was happening. She was terrified of the others laughing at her, they were laughing at herself. Her heart raced when she notices them shift as Adora. The blonde kneels beside her, and Catra flinches at the sight of them. She was weak at the sight of Adora, and everything else.

"Y'know, I never really liked cats. They always bore me, but, humor me! Do they really have nine lives? Can they swim?" The other asks.

The floor disappears as she falls into the ocean. They watch her fall, and they taunted her with every last second she had. Catra swam to the edge of the water, where a blank platform stood. She paces herself as her breathing intensifies and sobs into the platform's edge when she clings to it. The figure stands in front of her, before shapeshifting to its natural look.

"I'm over the theatrics, darling. My name is Double Trouble, D.T for short." They lean their hand forward for a handshake despite

seeing her struggle to stay afloat.

The feline tries to respond before she wakes up and her body jumps upward in the sheets. It was late at night, and the blonde still rested next to her. She looked down at herself and felt her own face as an in-the-moment reaction to what happened in her nightmare. She pants as she feels the sweat from her head drip down on her knees. She curls up and tries to sob quietly into her knees. How late was it? Surely Adora's new best friends made it back home.

Catra turns her head upwards and listens for any noise, but there was none other than crickets. She hears Adora's breathing, but nothing satisfies her paranoia when her heart races ever so slightly. She gently shakes the blonde's shoulder, and Adora makes an attempt to respond to her. She was half-awake, and the poor blonde looked too exhausted to really speak. The feline gets back up from the bed and goes to the bathroom across the room. She turns on the light and stares at herself in the mirror.

I'm a monster.

Catra felt the need to vomit whatever she held in as the faint images from her nightmare only haunt her. The impulsivity she had outweighed any rationale she felt. As a strategic woman with a complicated past, it did nothing for her but destroy anyone who comes across her path, and even herself. She studies her face in the reflection, and she knew immediately she couldn't hold on to what happened before. It was going to eat her alive.

She turns the knob off the sink, and she listens to the waterfall from the faucet. She cups her two hands to wash her face in the sink. As Catra turns her head to the mirror again, she notices a figure behind her. The fur on her body raises, and she screams, only to notice it was Adora standing there and watching her. She couldn't tell if she were real until she feels her waist in the arms of Adora. Her warmth was inviting, and she quickly leans into her. She couldn't hold down her guilt anymore.

"Hey... Adora?" Catra whispers.

"Hmm?" Adora makes a noise but she's too tired to speak.

"I'm ready to talk," Catra tears up as she sees her reaction.

Adora looks surprised at the other and she was baffled.

"Let's talk." The blonde responds to her.

The entire day has been devoted to conversation, but Catra thinks back to the days she fought every day to survive. It was natural instinct to her and all too familiar in a house that wasn't her own. Nothing felt real or natural anymore, and it triggered her fight or flight. She already gave up everything for Adora but nothing ever really satisfied the lonely lion. They were together alone and it

should've meant everything to Catra, she felt nothing but sorrow as old wounds opened up.

"We can run away, Adora. I'm thinking we can go North. Let's just leave. Let's forget it all, *please*." Catra begs.

"I... *what?* I can't do that, who's going to save everyone else? I can't just go." Adora answers.

You're so stupid. Please don't do this. Stay.

"Adora. For once in your life. Stop leaving me behind."

Adora presses a gentle hand against Catra's jaw as she cups it. She leans in gently as their foreheads touch, and Catra's ears go down at the embrace. The blonde lit up her world like the sunrise of early morning, and Catra was the one watching her. She closes her eyes, Adora was going to be the death of Force Captain. But they only had each other and that's all they could enjoy for now. They were each other's crutch. Love was a battle, a literal nightmare to express into words.

"I can only remember bits and pieces, everything's been so foggy lately. I don't get it because none of this feels real, but... don't sacrifice everything for everyone else." Catra's ears falter.

"I'm here, I'm here." Adora consoles her.

It never reassured Catra but this was the closest she could ever get with Adora. The Force Captain died at the touch of Adora's light as it left the shell of a woman tormented by her own anguish. She cannot imagine the world tomorrow, or next year, but she knows she has to stay at her side. It was the only way to receive love at her own expense.

self sacrifice

Chapter Summary

adora and catra relearn each other but unlearn the trauma they endured

Chapter Notes

this is promised with a happy ending next chapter! slight gore? not sure, but its catradora angst

edit: rewritten as of 2022

Life started feeling like ice and fire when Catra started to enter Adora's life. The complex and intense relationship they had used to be non-existent when Adora was willing to put their relationship away when Catra became Force Captain. Her feelings, however, never seemed to fade away when their dynamic changed them for the better and worse. For now, Adora only felt worse than usual. She woke up in an unfamiliar room and her head pounded from taking a blow that she couldn't remember.

"Try not to exert so much force, She-ra. After all, you're a guest tonight." An unfamiliar voice addresses her.

Green eyes watch Adora struggle inside the ropes. Her vision was clearing slowly as she notices a familiar figure walk across her. Adora could recognize the curve and tail shape anywhere, and to her surprise, she slowly starts to panic at who she was staring at. The slicked-back hair, the cold tone, and the change in her movements leave the blonde to stop moving in her tracks.

"Catra?" Adora calls to her in questioning.

The feline laughs coldly, and it was eerie. She doesn't answer Adora's question, but the cult-like uniform could give the slightest hint of what-who she is. The puppet-controlled Catra sits on Adora's waist, and she pulls her face to her own. Adora watches in terror as she attempts to find her pen, but it was out of her possession.

"Sounds like a personal problem," Catra's voice responds.

Adora feels herself get shoved away as Catra gets up. She examines her quickly and notices her eyes were off. She tries to go after her but the rope keeps her down, and the feline turns around and she kicks Adora's head, and knocks her out instantly. In the inner part of her head, Catra's yelling to stop but she has no control. She's watching herself in her own body and it terrifies her. For a moment, the body of Catra jolts back as the chip in her neck slams against the wall. Catra's eyes turn back as she looks down at the blonde before her. She tries to wake her before the moment was interrupted when she loses control. The feline lets go of Adora as she turns to walk off.

The room has no lighting, just the three screens that surrounded the young woman. The nearly pitch-black atmosphere made Catra carefully navigate about the perimeter, watching her step as her sharp eyes came across the familiar figure. Adora. She felt shivers of rage and betrayal travel down her spine, the sensation of agony making her fur bristle. A snarl escaped her throat as she charged

towards the warrior, claws unsheathed. She was ready to unravel her frustrations, but the sight of the situation before her brought her to a halt.

The blonde girl was disgruntled, blatantly bound at the wrists with overly-tightened handcuffs. She was grunting as she pulled at the chains in all her dismay. Her body struggled for freedom as her silhouette was surrounded by screens, monitoring and analyzing her placement. Speculating her every move as to make sure she didn't escape. Frustration and horror pierced her cerulean eyes. Catra was frozen in place as she observed Adora's position in mild shock. But she was quick to discard any sense of concern she held for her, and her fury quickly overtook her mind again. She slowly maneuvered herself towards Adora, tail laid straight back as she stalked towards her past friend like a predator upon prey.

"You did this to us, you did this to **me**." Catra growled, she didn't hesitate a moment as she inched closer to the bounded prey in front of her.

Adora listened for her voice, and she turns her head slightly. There was a sense of relieve that coursed through every bone that laid in her body. This is someone she knows she can completely place her faith and trust into, but something felt wrong. Her breathing labored as she struggled within her limiting restraints. Forced and fake laughter filtered the air she breathed, it continued everywhere as if it were an eternity. She calls out for her name, the only one that completed her personally. Her palms sweated, and her throat became dry at that very given point.

Catra, please get me out of here. My sword is on the table, just please.

Adora struggled once again, but there was no reassuring

response. Her internalized pleads mean absolutely nothing to her anymore. Catra's muscles begin to shift to her position, and her body pounces on top of the bounded girl who only winced and ache out in unforgiving pain. The feline's breathing begins to steady as she drags her nails around the weak girl's visible skin. She feels sick listening to her wail, but she's so tired of her. Adrenaline spikes through every moment she carries, and the blonde's skin is broken in front of her. This is only the beginning of their war, and they both knew of it. She swallows whatever wallowing guilt she's have had left.

"I really hate that you're breathing the same air as me right now." Catra spits out viciously.

Her elongated black claws latch inside of Adora, and she winces even more meanwhile struggling in her grasp. Adora's restraints hug her frail wrists tighter, and all she does is jerk her upper body upward to hopefully loosen the huntress' grip on her body. Her eyes are tearing up from the pain and sudden anguish that seemingly came out of nowhere to her. She has been hoping the past few days for Catra's appearance, but none of which would leave her wincing in further pain from her specifically.

"I can't believe you would even do this to *me!* I hate you!" Catra wails out.

She's now sobbing out, when all Adora has wanted nothing to do other than to comfort the woman above her. Her muffled sobs are censored by the duct tape against her mouth, it just makes her struggle even more. Adora's screaming for Catra's name, but none of her continuous pleads escape from her. She doesn't know how to warn her of the trap they're placed within, or how to explain her disappearance. Everything only spiraled around her and it was out of her own control now.

"*Shut up, shut up!* You left me! I hate the sound of your voice!" Catra roared painfully.

Catra notices Adora's struggles, but she isn't lashing back at her. There's no She-Ra and there's no strikes. She's panting aggressively and it's from her constant movement. Her constant anger that coursed through her veins and muscles, the tiresome revenge she has sought out. Her pointed eyes are dangerous to stare into, especially if they're now staring at you with sadness and misguided hatred. The feline is paranoid but it was never Adora's mistake at all.

Footsteps walk into the dark room, and it leaves both of the women a pause in their one-sided battle. His footsteps is heavy against the pavement, and his glowing red eyes screams intimidation at the both of them. Adora froze as she recognized the well-suited man who visited for the first time when she was picked up by a family her adoption day. The young woman swallows down her anguish, and these intensely sickening feelings punch at her gut. It's just a simple reminder that not everything was okay, or going to be at that moment. His voice gives the girl chills when he speaks.

"*Enough*, Force Captain. Rise." Hordak commands. His face is stoic, and it made Adora shift uncomfortably.

Catra doesn't speak, she has no words as of now. She lets the last of her tears fall in Adora's clawed backside. She watches how they mix with her blood awkwardly, she watches how the colors mix from clear to a shade of light red as the rest of it pours down her back. Guilt was still stabbing her insides as she stood up from the girl beneath her. She glances at her for a brief moment, she would

feel proud if it didn't make her so sick. The injuries she left, the blood escaping her, it was all to familiar and she's ridden with guilt when her rage soothes away.

Adora feels weight lift off of her shoulders quite literally when she stares at Catra. She tries to wince down her pain and try to recollect her thoughts in her unwanted situation she became forced under. Her best friend is angry, and the man talking has been associated with Catra longer than Adora has thought. She swallows her pain and pride down, and her tear filled cerulean-eyes studies both of the darkened silhouettes standing in front of her.

"Force Captain, you must prove your allegiance to the Horde, in doing so you must prepare for the end to She-Ra and resume normal operations after her disposal." Hordak deadpanned.

Wait, end to She-Ra?

Hordak grabs for the sword handle on the near side table, and he turns it upside down for the feline to hold. Catra's glowing eyes glare at it for a brief moment, seeming to have studied it when in reality she's hesitant. Her inner struggle with her demon only made her conflicted internally, if this was really what she wanted. On one hand, she hates everything but in the end she still loves Adora. She blinks when she reaches her hand mindlessly and she grabs for the handle. The man leans over by the wounded girl, and he rips the tape off of her mouth. He then gets up and makes his way to the door, he glares at Adora then to Catra before he leaves to his office.

"Do ***not*** hesitate."

The door slams shut, and Catra turns back to face Adora. Both of their eyes lock, but only Catra seems hesitant behind her smirk. Both of the screens turn on, and it only brightens the room slightly. It was enough to visibly see her face, and Adora's intimidation rose higher than her former egotistical attitude as She-Ra. The feline gets on her knees, and she points just the tip of the blade upon Adora's neck. Adora's heart skips a beat at the sight of the blade and she looks up at Catra. She struggles once more, and it causes her wounds to bleed out again.

"Catra please, you *don't* have to do this! You don't… I know you're not bad, we don't have to fight anymore. We… you can join me." Adora croaked as she breathes out when she speaks, the tension burning in her throat makes her nearly sob out.

"No, you don't get to call me *that!* Not everyone can be pulled into the light, She-Ra." Catra snaps, her chest starts heaving and her throats inflamed. She moves the tip of the blade a centimeter closer, but not to break skin.

Catra hesitates and it's obvious in her eyes. Her breathing is shaky and she stares at Adora in shock but she isn't able to feel her own rage spike up within herself. Her gaze doesn't leave the injured girl below, though her paranoia issues never really desist with her grip on the golden sword handle. She uses her free hand to caress Adora's tear soaked cheek. She brushes her hand against the tear and she moves the extra strands of her blonde hair to the side so she may see her heartbroken with please. Adora leans into her hand as she tries her hardest to gaze into her mixed colored eyes.

Please.

"I'm just...I'm *tired* of carrying so many lives on my shoulders. Don't you ever get tired of doing the same thing, Catra?" Adora murmurs against the feline's palm.

"What are you trying to *say?*" Catra interrogated, her palm becomes shaky and Adora takes immediate note of that.

"I think … I think I give up. You can finally have what you *always* wanted." She retorted with slight anger.

Catra's eyebrows furrowed and she pauses, then she pulls the blade back slightly. She frowns as her ears go down with her tail going in between her legs. Her pupil slits lay on Adora's facial expressions, and she can feel her own heart sink miles below her feet. There was too many emotions coursing through her that she didn't know what to feel, but she didn't want to do anything right.

Adora's tense as she watches the blade drop from her view. She's in shock and she looks at the now worried girl. Her muscles still feel tight and it seems like within any second she can collapse onto the hard floor. She doesn't want to give up, but there's only so much she can say to get the feline to drop what she can entirely, because Adora's stubborn and believes there is just redemption for anyone. However, in dire situations like these she's *scared*.

"Just… go." Catra grunted.

The feline reaches for Adora's wrist and she tugs on it to break the chains with the sword's blade. Catra's not even cautious when she drops the blade in front of the older girl. So much is going through both of their minds yet it is just difficult to comprehend

such an unlikely situation for the both of them. Adora's muscles become loose and her contact with Catra didn't fade whatsoever.

"Catra…" Adora trails off as she grabs for her hand.

Catra doesn't respond nor does she seem to fight her off at all. The huntress looks down at her hand and then at her, she begins to study her expressions. She sniffles a little, and only moves closer to her without making anymore body contact. After this given mess of miscommunication, she's frightened of who and *what* she has become over the past decade in a half. So hateful, and yet.. realistic to a world she isn't ready for.

I'm so sorry.

"I love you despite everything… I'm sorry." Adora confessed, and she gets up quickly to her feet.

Catra remained there with eyes widened with disbelief, because despite what she has done to Adora, through aggravated revenge, still loves her. The feline's tail flicked in confusion, and she covered her mouth to prevent any other tears to take form or to mask what she would have to say. She was absolutely in shock because she knew she wore down her relationship, let alone a friendship. She tries to ignore it as she stands on her feet to guide Adora through the exit of the building. The blonde's body aches as she tries to make way at the door.

"*Guards!* After those pesky traitors." Weaver calls into the hallway, outside of the room.

Once that call became made, the immediate response was Horde soldiers making their way into the room and flood it. The door opened and the room carried brighter lights. Soldiers in uniform, especially ones of bodies that look all-to-familiar for Adora to not ignore. Adora glares at them and Catra hisses, there was them versus the entirety of the world right now. As they dreamed when they were children, but this was a story entirely new. Adora lifts her sword regardless of the aggravating pain ripped into her back.

"For the Honor of–"

You will cause blood.

Before Adora may dare finish her chant, a dark shade of red escapes in the middle of her abdomen. Her eyes widen as she looks down at it, the liquid seeped out quickly against her white shirt. She starts to cough aggressively, and the blade that pierced within her pulled out immediately. Adora stands, but she knows she's empty inside. Blood escapes her lips, and she blubbers the words *'I'll find you'* to Catra*,* through her blood-stained lips. She lands on her knees, and she tries to reach out to the huntress. Her breathing slows down quickly, and she falls to the ground like a doll. The warrior's body lays frozen still as Catra watches her downfall.

"***Adora!***"

That's all Catra screams, she doesn't know what to say, so she doesn't speak. Her burning tears stabbed her vision and she scrapes her teeth against her tongue. Catra's muscle tense up and her chest is squeezed for her to barely breathe. Her tail waves all over with her breathing quickening at the sight of her lover taking a blow. She doesn't know if she's truly still alive or not, but she

doesn’t think of that now. She stares down at her for awhile, then she looks back at the soldier who commited a harmful crime. She hisses loudly and her chest burns as she snarls, the feline launches at the one who pierced her.

Rage.

The turmoil she has been through seemed all too unbearable. She kept scratching at the guard who harmed Adora in the worst way possible. She’s screaming, but that static in her head screamed louder than her. Her claws ripped through their helmet but she just keeps screaming and punching at him. When the other two guards try to restrain her, she easily pounces them quickly when they’re knocked down. The three guards leave in panic, they rush out the door and it’s quiet.

Catra quickly pace her way to Adora, and she holds her head in between her hands. Her ear flicks when she doesn’t hear anything, but she lays a hard kiss against her semi-cold lips. As her chest still aches, it finally releases any left over emotions she contained within herself. Her vision blurred for a minute when she has the moment to let her tears leave her with constant whimpering. Crying was for weakness, but she’s below weak. Noises followed her crying and her eyebrows furrowed once again. She lifted the blonde’s upper body up, she takes the pen into the warrior’s pocket, and the feline tries to drag her to the way she entered the building entirely. She cries once she moves the both of them, and it became hard to speak without wanting to sob out.

“I...I hate that you left me, just *please don’t* this time.”

The reminder of what Shadow Weaver has told her, haunted her.

And it will be by your hands.

changes within

Chapter Summary

catra and adora learn to place trust in each other, and they start to truly move on

Chapter Notes

this is the last chapter! the ending for this au is open because i might continue it, im not sure. if you would love to see more please let me know!

edited: 2021

”I’m *always* here for you, you *know* that. I never meant to make you feel like my enemy. You were never second best from me, I left this group because of *what* they done. I don’t like how I ended up after someone gave me a chance, I want you to feel that love I got after leaving. You can join me! You can still be by my side.” She-ra shouted.

She-ra’s monologue strikes her as she kept her wits up downtown during one of her many famous battles against Force Captain. Sunset has taken place during their excruciating battle that left the both of the girl’s sore to their feet. The air was covered in smoke, which usually Force Captain would retreat into for safety against the various burns threatening her skin and safety. Some buildings were destroyed in the aftermath of their dependent war. Adora became a weapon, but not for any particular group. Something about the blonde girl made her morena skin crawl, even by witnessing first hand that She-Ra is more than what she is capable of. A disaster.

“Gago! (Idiot!) You *don’t know* the endgame, She-ra. I’m not *your* sidekick! It’s more than changing sides!” Catra screams at her, and

her breath quickens.

The feline leans backward and she lunges forward at She-ra from the top of a van. She raises her hand as her fierce black claws extend from her fingertips, she then strikes the golden gauntlet that rang vibrations against her feline ears. Catra growls furiously when her body lands easily by catching herself onto the sidewalk near both of them.

"You ***lied*** to me! You lied about *everything!* We spent our entire life together and you throw it all away! For what? Better friends? I'll *never* join you, go use someone else!" Catra hisses as she tried to hold back her tears.

Catra held her breath as she tries to drag the unconscious girl by her arms. The events that happened moments before left her in an unsettling amount of guilt and anguish. No one prepared her for this, other than Weaver and Hordak themselves.

Monsters. Down the hallway laid guards on the floor. She listened to the ominous voices in the empty room, it sounded familiar but she couldn't risk her efforts in getting the both of them to safety. As Adora groans when she's sluggishly dragged in the hall, Catra paces as she finds a room next to them. She opens the door, and there only laid a bed and two other doors that lead to a closet and a bathroom. She pulls Adora inside quickly when the door slaps the wounded girl's leg then to shut.

Fuck, fuck, fuck!

“It’s okay, it’s okay, we’re safe for now.” Catra reassures the barely unconscious girl.

Catra tries to elevate the blonde girl into the bed to best of her ability. She lays Adora onto the bed straight, and she tries to apply pressure to the wound with the blanket. Worry burns in her chest and it could explode any second. Her vision blurred once again as she tries to let the anguish out of her heart when her tears escaped her vision. She rips a long strip of the sheet with her own nails to use it as a temporary bandage when she ties it around Adora.

It was by my hands, sure, whatever Weaver. But you raised me this way.

Revenge is another option on her bucket list, but her priorities right now needed to settle down first before she even considers Weaver’s demise. Catra huffs, and she presses harder onto the two inch gash in Adora’s abdomen. Her breathing becomes shaky as she realizes she’s not only outnumbered, but outmatched. Her phone was broken and Adora’s ended up missing from her.

Catra wanted to move and scream for help like a child getting lost at a large store. Her hope seemed dim as she tries to weigh out her limited options. First-Aid. Retreat. Back-up. Break down.

Adora winced upon the pressure and excruciating pain. Catra responds to her with a gentle kiss to the blonde’s forehead which felt like forgotten sparks. Her heart thumped every second as time passed, she grabs Adora’s hand to keep it pressed to her wound as she gets up from her in search of the First-Aid kit through cabinets and possibly sink water for the both of them. She sweats nervously and all of the pressure made her head pound to her

heart. She wants to cry, she wants to scream, but she can't.

"*Found* you!" The shrilling voice makes Catra squeal and freeze into place. Her hearts pounding faster than time, and she doesn't turn around.

Fear struck her down hard and she's never been this afraid of anything since she nearly killed Adora. The bristles of hair on her neck stands with her tail and still hair. She's trembling all over as her forehead felt warm. The feline barely felt her muscles move, and her chest tensed at even the slight thought of getting caught. Her closed pupils turn to the left as her own claws extend from her fingers.

"I've been looking for you Catra! You haven't been replying to my texts and I was so worried! No ones replying to my 'Super Pal Trio' chat!" Scorpia exclaims as she frowns.

Catra releases the unwanted tension in her body as she turns around to face Scorpia. Her paranoia really is high, enough to make her feel nauseous. She tries to swallow it down and ignore what happened moments ago. She releases her held in breath and her hair goes down with it. She wipes the sweat from her forehead and she looks up at the muscular girl who offered such a radiating smile.

"Listen, I really don't have a lot of time. Get your First-Aid kit out, a cup of water, and your phone. I'm gonna text Glitter and Bow." Catra explains quickly as she points to the bed.

Scorpia's eyebrows lifted upward and she made an *'oh'* noise with her mouth. She gazes at the girl who breathed slowly then at the

obvious wound that barely stayed covered with her hand and blanket. The image only caused her to scowl at the sight of her. Instead of questioning it, her tail curled when she nodded at the distressed feline. She takes the phone from her pocket and she hands it to the huntress with ease. The muscular girl swallows as she makes her way to the cabinet next to Catra, she takes the kit out for the feline's view before walking over aside Adora and opening it for her.

Scorpia<3 :) 9:47PM
glitter, it's catra. adoras hurt. i want to take her home

Scorpia<3 :) 9:48PM
ive been shitty to you but… please, she's weaker

Adora's disoriented as she tries to shift on the bed. She wakes up slightly, and her vision is blurred while her head is spinning. She moves her hand on Scorpia's pincer with a half-hearted giggle. Her stomach lost a good amount of blood, which didn't help her none. Internally she's absolutely horrified of the situation, but her brain limited her freedom to express it. Her gaze is on the shorter hair girl who opened the disgustingly soaked bandage off of her. She winces at the pain, but her off-smile doesn't leave her until her eyes close again.

Fuck.

Scorpia watches her awkwardly and she's scared beyond the point of no return. She opens the kit, and then she lifts Adora's shirt slightly. Blood oozes out of her gash and it makes the poor girl want to hurl, but she refrains to grab at the shirt again. She leans to look at the kit, she grabs for a needle and thread, bandages, peroxide, and ibuprofen. She looks at her claws, and she knows

she can’t do this even if she learned it at Force Captain Orientation. The muscular girl faces Catra and calls to her.

“Catra, I can’t necessarily, um…” Scorpia scoffed embarrassingly.

“Move over.” Catra demands shakily.

The feline walks to the bed and she then kneels beside Scorpia, she looks at the items laid out in front of her and her tail-flicks when she remembers the night of Christmas Eve. She grabs for the needle and thread, and she gets to work trying to close the gash in her abdomen and on her back. The sewing isn’t her best work, but there is only so much she can work with right now. As she does this, she gives Adora occasional glances but she seemed to be asleep as her breathing remained calm. It relieved Catra once she finished her work on Adora, then she covers both ends with a large bandage. She’s scared.

“Scorpia, you need to let us stay until we can go.” Catra demands as she tears up.

Scorpia nods in response as she looks at her dear friend. She knows Catra has experienced everything rough and what no one should ever go through when it comes to a loved one whether they’re friends or not. She’s sympathetic and she expresses that with a gentle hug to the feline that finally stopped fighting her affection off. It felt foreign for Scorpia for Catra to not fight hugging off, if this situation broken her that much then Scorpia would have hugged her all of the time then.

Catra doesn’t know how to respond, or what to do. She doesn’t fight off the affection but she neither denies it. For the first time

in years, she found herself hopeless in a position outside of her control. She wants to control situations for her better outcome, even if it meant retaliating in the worst of ways. After the hug, she pulls away while wiping the trembling tears that left her eyes. Her tail flicks and she looks down at Adora. Her chest heavy and tight, and she knows she caused everything throughout this mess.

"Adora, I'm sorry for everything. I didn't know this was gonna happen, I..." Catra trails off.

Tears swelled up her vision and the tension in her chest and throat only worsened. The events she has experienced could never prepare her for this moment. Catra leans upward to look at Adora clearly, and the knot in her gut gets tighter. She moves her right hand to brush the extra hair laying out of the blonde's ponytail, then she removes the ponytail entirely for Adora to feel comfortable. Her breathing becomes all too shaky, she decides to shift slightly and to plant a gentle kiss against her pale temple.

Scorpia watches as she places her pincer upon Catra's toned back as her way of expressing sympathy and comfort for the guilt-ridden feline. Her gaze then shifts to Adora and then to her injury. She gets up and picks up the blood-soaked sheet to throw away. As it gets lifted upward, the red liquid seeped into the flooring and against her foot. She finds the trash-can in the corner of her room and she drops it into there.

"It'll be okay, Catra. Don't worry. The guards probably think you escaped." Scorpia attempts to smile at the mourning girl.

Yeah, right.

Before Catra can mutter a word, her ear twitches at Adora's breathing. She turns to face her once more, and she notices there were no more noise coming from the wounded blonde girl. No. Her expression of worry to heartache takes control of her and she grips onto Adora. *Please*. Adora's mouth is gaping open with her head laying to the side. When no noise is made from her self-proclaimed lover, she moves her ear against her chest. There's no noise, none. She feels her heart drop to her knees. It skips a beat inside of her, and she's sobbing loudly. Time was in her hands and it froze itself.

"Adora, Adora, please." Catra pleads shakily when tears escape from her.

It should've been me. Not her, not now.

Adora moves when Catra maneuvers her slightly, her eyes open a little but her vision remained blurred from disorientation. She looks down at the dark haired girl crying out for her against her leg. She feels worry but she feels too weak to move so much, so she jerks her leg for Catra to know she's okay. Her confusion worries her and to the sobbing it made her so sad, but she barely could must the energy to speak so much. There was only words to muster from her own mouth to indicate she's okay, at least consciously. Even if she were out cold, she heard what she could from the both of them.

"Catra…" Adora muttered as her half-lidded gaze didn't leave her.

Thank diyosa (god).

Her ears perk at her speaking, and she feels herself break down

harder. She moves over to hug Adora quickly, and her grip doesn't drop whatsoever. A sense of relief and heartbreak escaped her sobs and whimpering out for her. Catra feels the warmth of the wounded girl's skin and she plants another kiss upon Adora's lips. The anger, the sadness, the guilt, and joy seeped through her movements. She's in turmoil after the events broke her consequently.

The blonde looks at her in surprise by the quick and steady movements. Her vision is adjusting to the light so it isn't far of disorientation for her, nonetheless it was still difficult for her to do much. When Catra plants a kiss on her lips, and Adora responds the same kiss in return. She moves her hands to stroke her short hair. As wounded as she is, the pain never took the joy she feels when she's with the feline for a majority of the time. She tries to lean upward despite her agonizing pain and she gives a kiss to her forehead before going back down.

"... Ow, jeez." Adora mumbles.

Scorpia watches the endearing and tender moment as it leaves her with a gentle smile. She feels overwhelmed with relieve for Adora's safety. She moves from the trash-can to the bottle of water she had on her an hour ago from when she trained in the exercising rooms. She grabs for it and goes back to Adora while Catra held the ibuprofen in her hand.

"Drink this with the ibuprofen! It won't do much but it's better than nothing, we still need to get you to the infirmary or hospital." Scorpia announced.

"She-ra will be fine, as long as I…" Adora shifts uncomfortably as her pain leaves her off trail.

“Transform.” She adds on.

“Adora, don’t.” Catra retorted.

“I’ll heal faster after transforming. It’s a long-story.” Adora chortled with a gentle smile.

Catra paused and took a moment. A part of her didn’t want to see her transform, she’s worried and paranoid for her health and safety. On another hand, she just wanted to leave without ever having to remember this place or the consequences she’ll face if she returns someday or stays for that time being. She gazes at Adora before sighing and looking away for a brief moment. She reaches for Adora’s pocket and she pulls out her pen for her.

“Here.” Catra muttered in frustration.

Adora looks down at the pen then back at Catra, she takes the pen into her hand and she grips it as hard as she could. She looks at Catra straight away, then she leans into her for a kiss. Once the kiss is broken, she gives a small smile as a reminder that she isn’t mad or angry at her for the miscommunication neither of them were aware of.

“I forgive you. I love you too.” Adora admits as she combs her dark hair with her fingers.

Catra stares at her dumbfounded. She realizes Adora could still hear her conversations even when being placed in an unconscious

situation. She didn’t mind it all, this is someone she’s longed for admittedly. Adora’s pride sent her skin crawling, but she ignored that for her. She loves her more than anything, even if her own pride can blind side her with the benefit of a doubt. She looks at her with a small smile, but nothing else regarding that.

Adora looks back at the pen as she studies it. She remembers the direction and place she held it in. She remembered Weaver clicked on it, she remembered the moment before she got stabbed. A lot of it seemed peculiar to her, especially after the incident that nearly left her for dead. She looked back at Catra who looked more worried than ever, then at Scorpia who expressed concern for her well-being too. She clicked the device, and the noise it made left her in awe as she looked at her own reflection through it.

In a flash, her transformation left her as a golden warrior who was eight feet-tall and she could stand on her feet. Her hair shined as a bright blonde, and her crown formed with her white-polished uniform. She looked down at the both of them as she left the bed. The light went away and her wounds did too, however her mental scar would remain. She looked at Catra, and grabbed her hand into her larger one. The feline looked at her hand then back up at her. She was conflicted about She-Ra but she trusted Adora with all of her might. Catra looked up at her, and she got on her toes to reach for a pathetic attempt at a kiss.

She-ra smiled, then she leaned downward to press her lips against Catra’s feverish ones. She broke it quickly as she heard an excited squeal from Scorpia, who they both forgot shared the same room as them. Catra hid her face while Adora smiled at the honest gesture from the muscular girl. Scorpia smiled back, and her scorpion tail curled as she did so.

“Good luck!” Scorpia says excitedly.

“Yeah, we’ll need it.” Catra responds.

The feline is still too unsure of everything happening right now, she wasn’t sure if she’ll go with Adora but after everything that has happened to her the past three months, it was considerable. She choked down her frustrated feelings to grip Adora’s large hand. She looked at her through enamoured awe while her tail flicked then curled at the sight of her. It was scary, all of this, but maybe it’ll be worth it now.

She-ra makes her way to the door, only to wince slightly when she gets down from the bed. There was no evidential pain or physical wounding, but there laid soreness on the various spots Adora dealt with in the Horde’s chamber. Looking at her still being sore only made the feline wince with guilt and frustration. When Adora opened the door slightly, her breathing got quiet to adjust to anyone with sensitive hearing, she pokes her eye out and there was no one suspiciously to be seen.

“*Adora?*” A soft but high familiar voice echoes through the hallway.

The blonde warrior pokes her head out to find a lost Glimmer teleporting with Bow near their door. She opens the bedroom door immediately and when they spot her, they rush to her through worry. Bow looks excited and so does Glimmer until she spots Catra next to her. Bow didn’t mind as much since he’s more welcoming than anyone in existence. Her skeptical expressions already spoke volumes to Catra and she growls under her breath.

“Adora!” Bow squeals excitedly.

“What’s *Catra* doing with you?” Glimmer groans.

“Well, *Dimmer*, did I ask for you to come?” Catra says in aggravation.

“It’s *Glimmer!* Yeah, you did!” Glimmer responds as she clenches her fists.

“Guys, let’s just focus. Glimmer, can’t you just teleport us out of here?” Adora interrupts in a rush.

“I.. can, but it’ll use up all of my power.” Glimmer says through remorse, not wanting to share that in front of Catra, of all people.

“It’s the best we got. Please.” Adora panics when footsteps are heard making way into the hall they’re inside of.

Adora grips the both of them while Glimmer held onto her and Bow who seemed particularly worried. With another bright flash, they exited their way from the isolated building and into the cold night air. They’re outside in the forest, but Glimmer trembles sheepishly into the snow weakly. They’re all shivering as some of them could even see their breath in the cold air. The temperature was barely higher than three degrees Fahrenheit. Adora looks at the three of them, then at the now held Glimmer carried by Bow.

“It’s okay Adora, we didn’t have a lot of options. We *need to go*,

Angella drove us here in case things go wrong. I'll meet you back at the car." Bow says hurriedly when he makes his way through trees to follow the path that Catra once stepped through to hunt for Adora.

The two girls left there watch him until his shadowed silhouette gets further from their view. It was late into the night, where the weather stabbed at She-Ra's sore spots. She shivered slightly but tries her best to not acknowledge it and to pace her attention onto Catra. She knows she can't convince her to go with her as She-Ra, but if she tried as Adora it would be worse and a different story neither of them wanted to think about.

"Catra, if you stay here they'll imprison you. Maybe even worse, you saved me today." Adora places a hand on Catra's arm.

Through the troubles they both went through, is it really worth it? To join everything you fought against? Everything that drowned you through alcohol and left you for dead in a lonely apartment?

No, but I want to go home.

Catra looks up at her and her tail flicks at the statement. It was true, and inevitable to ignore. She felt a need to take responsibility for the ultimate damage she's caused, the consequence of her power. It welcomed her and it can reject her a easily with closed arms. She thought for a moment as she shivered at the awfully cold weather.

"I'm still not joining your stupid rebellion, but I just want to leave." Catra admits to her defeat.

Adora nods understandingly to the huntress' surprise. She held Catra for a moment, and she tries to fight the urge to let go since her injuries tried to heal while they worsened simultaneously. The blonde warrior presses a kiss against Catra's cheek, which became interrupted as the feline moved to her lips instead. The fire ignited fiercely because she held her own match and paper for Adora.

I missed you.

"Let's go home, Catra." Adora responds.

"***Adora***." Doctor Hope repeated herself.

The room was pitch silent, the time was 2:30PM in Doctor Hope's therapy sessions. Silence remained at bay but both of their attention didn't. It was sunny outside of the window, and the snow melted with the sunlight. Adora looked out at it then she faced back forward to the woman who still looked similar to her guide. She never questioned it, after through so many events it was difficult.

So this is the shit Adora does once a week?

Catra rolls her eyes when Adora turns around to face her surprised. The blush on Adora's cheek made her smile. The feline pulls her feet off of the Doctor's desk, and she gets up to walk around the room impatiently for this to end, which is hopefully

soon. It was always repetitive at her counseling sessions, it is usually Adora zoning out to the night or days before each inevitable session she shares with her guide. For the feline, she knew she had to go with her since that dreadful day.

I swear to god this doesn't do anything for me. It's so boring.

The feline shifts her jacket as the Doctor speaks. She barely even listens anymore since it's the same thing every time. Catra looks at the red varsity jacket Adora had given her to wear, and she smiles at it softly before inhaling its scent.

"Whaaaat are you *doing?*" Adora chortled with a snort.

Shit.

"Nothing! It smelled bad. Fuck off!" Catra said defensively, though her blush says something else.

The session ended a while ago without Catra noticing, and she grabs Adora's hand to intertwine their fingers when they left the eerily silent office. When leaving through the doors and down the stairs, there was so many questions Catra pondered upon involving their home, classes, and the typical things anti-hero/ex-villains do. It remained quiet as they listened to the people walking by or the cars in traffic. When they made way to the parking lot, Catra grabbed the keys from the jacket pocket.

"Catra, have you considered where you're at now? Like, are you done being *Force Captain?*" Adora asks suddenly.

The huntress took a moment to process what she had said, but none of it really came to her. She still wanted to keep the mask and that role, but she isn't entirely what you call heroic. She refrained from heroism and imprisoning criminals as it inevitably leads to nowhere for her. She unlocks her car for the both of them to get into. She opens the door and settles in her seat meanwhile Adora did too, but with her usual worried expressions.

"No. Sorry, Princess. I didn't join your little rebellion and I left the Horde. I like doing my own thing anyway." Catra admitted while starting up the engine.

Adora looks surprised. "That's *bad!* Regardless of who the criminals are, it's your right to help them-"

Catra snorts. "Blah blah, we talk about this so much. Scorpia and Entrapta agreed with me, then that's it. I'll help you sometimes. I like what we have going on, Adora." The feline sighs. "Let's give this talk a break for once, I wanna talk about us."

"What about us?" Adora asks as her eyes widen.

"Back to your question months ago, I really *do* want to go out with you." Catra says nervously.

"R-Really? Oh!" Adora trailed off. "Let's go to the movies then! It's on me."

Catra didn't know how to respond but only to give a gentle snort

and a laugh. Her cheeks flushed red slightly and she held the blonde's hand again with their fingers locking into place. Adora gave a surprised and flustered laugh, where Catra smiled in response to her. She leaned over, and pressed her lips against Adora's gentle ones. After she had returned the kiss, Catra leaned her head against the jock's shoulder.

"You can pick the movie tonight. I promise we're both off from working for awhile." Catra smiles firmly.

"It's a date then!"

End Notes

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